

SGA 5 — Exposé I

Dualizing Complexes

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Introduction

This exposé is devoted to the biduality theorem in étale cohomology. The theory developed here and in SGA A XVIII (SGA A = SGA 4), for the étale topology and constructible torsion sheaves on preschemes, is formally very analogous to the one developed in HARTSHORNE [H] for the Zariski topology and coherent sheaves: the latter served, to a very large extent, as its model. But, whereas in the case of “continuous” coefficients the existence of dualizing complexes presents no difficulties, in the case of “discrete” coefficients, on the other hand, it is much more delicate to prove, and it seems to require resolution of singularities in an essential way. See however Deligne’s biduality theorem (SGA 4^{1/2}, Finiteness Theorem 4.3.).

Paragraph 1 contains the definition of dualizing complexes and the formal properties that follow from it, notably the interpretation of dualizing functors as “exchangers of functors.”

In paragraph 2, one shows that, on a connected locally noetherian prescheme, a dualizing complex is determined uniquely, up to a translation of degrees and tensoring by an invertible sheaf.

In paragraph 3, one comes to the central theorem of the exposé (3.4.1.), which asserts that, on a “good” regular prescheme X , for example on an excellent noetherian regular prescheme of characteristic zero¹, the complex $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X$ is dualizing.

Paragraph 4 gives the applications of the theory to the local duality theorem. The latter expresses that, on a “good” prescheme X endowed with a closed point x whose residue field is separably closed, and for a constructible sheaf F , one has a perfect pairing between $\underline{H}_x^i(F')$ and $\underline{H}_x^{-i}(F)$, where F' is the dual of F , i.e. $F' = R\underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(F, K_X)$, where K_X is a dualizing complex.

Finally, in paragraph 5, one proves directly that on a regular prescheme of dimension 1 the complex $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X$ is dualizing (n prime to the residual characteristics).

1 Definition and formal properties of dualizing complexes

We fix a coefficient ring $A = \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. If X is a prescheme, we denote by A_X the constant sheaf on $X_{\text{ét}}$ with value A , and by $D(X)$ the derived category of the category of A_X -modules. We denote, on the other hand, by $D_c(X)$ the full triangulated subcategory of $D(X)$ formed by the complexes F such that $H^i(F)$ is a constructible A_X -module for every i . We put $D_c^*(X) = D^*(X) \cap D_c(X)$, where $*$ = $\emptyset$, $+$, $-$, or b .

¹This last restriction will become unnecessary once one has resolution of singularities à la Hironaka for these preschemes, and the “purity theorem.”

Definition 1.1

An A_X -module I is said to be *quasi-injective* if one has

$$\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^i(F, I) = 0$$

for every *constructible* A_X -module F and every $i > 0$.

Remarks 1.2

- a) Contrary to what happens in the case of “continuous” coefficients (cf. [H] II.7.17), a quasi-injective sheaf is not injective in general. For example, let $X = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{R})$ and $A = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$: the sheaf A_X is quasi-injective, but is not injective, nor even of finite injective dimension, since $H^*(X; A_X) = H^*(\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}; \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z})$ is a polynomial algebra on one generator of dimension 1.
- b) Let I be a quasi-injective A_X -module. It is false in general that the relation $\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^i(F, I) = 0$ for $i > 0$, valid for constructible F , is valid for every F . Indeed, take $A = \mathbb{F}_\ell$. Let k be a field, $\bar{k}$ a separable closure of k , and $f : \bar{x} = \mathrm{Spec}(\bar{k}) \rightarrow X = \mathrm{Spec}(k)$ the canonical morphism, and suppose that, for every connected étale covering $X' \rightarrow X$, there exists a connected étale covering $X'' \rightarrow X'$ such that $[X'' : X']$ is divisible by ℓ (take, for example, $k = \mathbb{Q}$). Consider the exact sequence

$$(*) \quad 0 \longrightarrow A_X \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} f_* f^* A_X \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow 0$$

defined by the adjunction arrow ε . In view of the hypothesis, the section of $\mathrm{Ext}^1(F, A_X)$ defined by $(*)$ does not vanish above any U étale over X ; hence $\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^1(F, A_X)_{\bar{x}} \neq 0$. But one checks trivially that A_X is quasi-injective.

Proposition 1.3 (cf. [H] 1.7.6)

Let X be a prescheme and $N \in \mathbb{Z}$. The following conditions on $K \in \mathrm{ob} D^+(X)$ are equivalent:

- (i) K is isomorphic, in $D(X)$, to a bounded complex I such that I^i is quasi-injective for every i and zero for $i > N$;
- (ii) for every $F \in \mathrm{ob} D_c^b(X)$ such that $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i < 0$, one has $\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^i(F, K) = 0$ for $i > N$;
- (iii) for every constructible A_X -module F , one has $\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^i(F, K) = 0$ for $i > N$.

Proof. (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Let $F \in \mathrm{ob} D_c^b(X)$ be such that $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i < 0$, and let $I \in \mathrm{ob} D^+(X)$ be bounded and such that I^i is quasi-injective for every i and zero for $i > N$; we show that $\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^i(F, I) = 0$ for $i > N$. Arguing by induction on the number of indices i such that $H^i \neq 0$, one is reduced, by dévissage, to the case where $N = 0$ and I is concentrated in degree 0. One then has a biregular spectral sequence

$$E_2^{pq} = \underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^p(H^{-q}(F), I) \Rightarrow \underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^*(F, I).$$

Since I is quasi-injective, $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $p > 0$ and every q , and hence one has $E_2^{0i} = \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(H^{-i}(F), I) \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^i(F, I)$, which gives the conclusion.

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii) is trivial.

(iii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) We may suppose that K is bounded below and has injective components. The hypothesis, applied to $F = A_X$, implies that $H^i(K) = 0$ for $i > N$. We may therefore replace K by an isomorphic complex K' , bounded, and such that K'^i is injective for $i < N$ and zero for $i > N$. It is then observed that $K'^{!N}$ is quasi-injective, which completes the proof.

Remark 1.3.1

The writer does not know whether (1.3) is still true when, in condition (ii), the hypothesis “ $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ ” is replaced by “ $F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$ ”.

Definition 1.4

The *quasi-injective dimension* of K , denoted $\dim . q. inj(K)$, is the lower bound (in $\overline{\mathbb{R}}$) of the integers N satisfying the equivalent conditions of (1.3).

If K is of finite quasi-injective dimension, the functor $R \underline{\text{Hom}}(_, K) : D(X) \rightarrow D(X)$ induces a functor $D_c^b(X) \rightarrow D^b(X)$.

We shall see below that if X is smooth of dimension d over a field k and n is prime to the characteristic of k , then $\dim . q. inj(A_X) = 2d$.

The example of (1.2 a)) shows that a complex of finite quasi-injective dimension is not necessarily of finite injective dimension. Nevertheless one has:

Proposition 1.5

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$. Suppose that there exists an integer N such that $\text{cd}_{\mathbf{n}}(X) \leq N$, where $\mathbf{n}$ is the set of prime divisors of n (notation of SGAA X 1). Then, for $N' \in \mathbb{Z}$, one has

$$\dim . q. inj(K) \leq N' \implies \dim . inj(K) \leq N + N'.$$

We shall use, in the proof, the following

Lemma 1.5.1

Let C be an abelian category satisfying (AB5) and possessing a family of generators $(U_i)_{i \in I}$. Let $K \in \text{ob } D^+(C)$ and $N \in \mathbb{Z}$. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) $\dim . inj(K) \leq N$;
- (ii) for every $i \in I$ and every quotient F of U_i , one has

$$\text{Ext}^n(F, K) = 0 \quad \text{for } n > N.$$

Proof. It suffices to prove (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i). By a well-known argument (cf. for example [H] 1.7.6), one is reduced to showing that if $K' \in \text{ob}(C)$ is such that $\text{Ext}^1(F, K') = 0$ every time F is a quotient of a U_i , then K' is injective. In other words, one has to prove that, if every morphism from a subobject

V of a U_i into K' extends to U_i , then K' is injective. But this follows immediately from the proof of Lemma 1, p. 136 of (Tohoku).

Proof of (1.5). Suppose $\dim .q.inj(K) \leq N'$ and prove $\dim .inj(K) \leq N + N'$. Since the category of A_X -modules admits as generators the $A_{U,X}$ where U is étale of finite type over X , it suffices, by (1.5.1), to prove that $\text{Ext}^i(X; F, K) = 0$ for $i > N + N'$ when F is a quotient of such an $A_{U,X}$, hence constructible (SGAA IX 2.9). Consider the spectral sequence

$$E_2^{pq} = H^p(X; \underline{\text{Ext}}^q(F, K)) \Rightarrow \text{Ext}^*(X; F, K).$$

The hypothesis $\text{cd}_n(X) \leq N$ (resp. $\dim .q.inj(K) \leq N'$) implies $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $p > N$ (resp. $q > N'$). Hence $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $p + q > N + N'$, whence the conclusion.

Remark 1.5.2

The hypothesis of (1.5) is verified (with $N = 2d$) if X is a prescheme of finite type and dimension d over a separably closed field k , with n prime to $\text{char}(k)$ (SGAA X 4).

Proposition 1.6

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a separated quasi-finite morphism of noetherian preschemes, and let $K \in \text{ob } D^+(Y)$. Then, for $N \in \mathbb{Z}$, one has

$$\dim .q.inj(K) \leq N \quad \implies \quad \dim .q.inj(R^!f(K)) \leq N.$$

Proof. According to the “Main theorem” (EGA IV 8.12.6), there exists a factorization of f as $f = uf'$, where f' is an open immersion and u is a finite morphism. We have $R^!f = R^!f' R^!u$, which reduces us to examining separately the case of an open immersion and that of a finite morphism. If f is an open immersion, the assertion is trivial (since every constructible sheaf on X is then induced by a constructible sheaf on Y). Suppose therefore that f is a finite morphism, and let F be a constructible A_X -module. We then have the duality isomorphisms (SGAA XVIII 3.1.9.6)

$$f_* \underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, R^!f(K)) \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{\text{Ext}}^i(f_* F, K).$$

Since $f_*(F)$ is constructible (SGAA IX 2.14), it follows that, if $\dim .q.inj(K) \leq N$, then $f_* \underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, R^!f(K)) = 0$ for $i > N$, hence $\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, R^!f(K)) = 0$ for $i > N$ (SGAA VIII 5.5), as required.

Let now X be a prescheme, and let $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$. Denote by $\underline{D}_K$ the functor $R \underline{\text{Hom}}(-, K)$. We shall define, for $F \in \text{ob } D(X)$, a functorial homomorphism $F \rightarrow \underline{D}_K \underline{D}_K F$ (cf. [H] V.1.2). The construction which follows would be valid more generally on a ringed topos. We may first suppose that K is formed of injectives, which allows us to “remove the R ”. The identity morphism $\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K) \rightarrow \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K)$ defines, by the formula dear to Cartan, a homomorphism $F \otimes \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K) \rightarrow K$, whence, by a second application of the said formula, a homomorphism $F \rightarrow \underline{\text{Hom}}(\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K), K)$, which is the announced homomorphism, and which we baptize the canonical homomorphism. We say that the pair (F, K) is *bidualizing*, or *satisfies biduality*, or again that F is *reflexive* relative to K , if the canonical homomorphism $F \rightarrow \underline{D}_K \underline{D}_K F$ is an isomorphism.

From now on, unless expressly mentioned otherwise, all preschemes considered will be assumed lo

Definition 1.7

Let X be a prescheme. A complex $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ is said to be *dualizing* if the following conditions are satisfied:

- (i) K is of finite quasi-injective dimension;
- (ii) for every $F \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$, one has $\underline{D}_K(F) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$;
- (iii) every $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ is reflexive relative to K .

Remark 1.8

- a) By a standard dévissage (truncating F and using the fact that $D_c(X)$ is triangulated), one sees that condition (ii) is equivalent to
(ii bis): for every constructible A_X -module F and every $i \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, K)$ is constructible.
- b) Condition (ii bis) implies $K \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$. Contrary to the example of coherent sheaves (EGA 0_{III} 12.3.3), the converse is perhaps not automatically verified. It is however verified (see no. 3) in the “good” cases, for example when one has on X resolution of singularities and purity (in particular if X is an excellent prescheme of characteristic zero).
- c) By dévissage on F , one sees that condition (iii) is equivalent to (iii bis): every constructible A_X -module F is reflexive relative to K .
- d) If $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ satisfies (i) and (ii) (resp. is dualizing), the functor $\underline{D}_K$ induces a functor (resp. an equivalence of categories) $(D_c^b(X))^\circ \rightarrow D_c^b(X)$.
- e) If $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ is of finite *injective* dimension (cf. 1.5.2) and satisfies (ii), then, for every $F \in \text{ob } D_c(X)$, one has $\underline{D}_K(F) \in D_c(X)$, and $\underline{D}_K$ induces a functor $(D_c^+(X))^\circ \rightarrow D_c^-(X)$.
If moreover K is dualizing, every $F \in \text{ob } D_c(X)$ is reflexive relative to K , and $\underline{D}_K$ induces equivalences of categories

$$(D_c(X))^\circ \xrightarrow{\sim} D_c(X), \quad (D_c^-(X))^\circ \xrightarrow{\sim} D_c^+(X), \quad (D_c^+(X))^\circ \xrightarrow{\sim} D_c^-(X).$$

It is not known whether this conclusion remains valid without the restriction that K be of finite injective dimension.

We now turn to the “exchange formulas.” We shall not return to the notion of the tor-dimension of a complex, see SGA A, Exposé XVII, 4.1.9, and also SGA 6, I, 5. Retain only the following point: if X is a prescheme and $G \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$, the condition $\underline{\text{Tor}}_i(F, G) = 0$ for $i > N$ and all A_X -modules F is equivalent to the same condition with F constructible, by SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.9 and the commutation of tensor product with filtered inductive limits. Thus there is no need to introduce a notion of “quasi-tor-dimension.”

Lemma 1.9, cf. [H] II.4.3.

- a) Let X be a prescheme and let $F, G \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$. One has $F \otimes^L G \in \text{ob } D_c(X)$ if $F \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$, or if G has finite tor-dimension.

b) Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of preschemes and let $G \in \text{ob } D_c^-(Y)$. Then $f^*(G) \in \text{ob } D_c(X)$.

Proof. Part (b) follows trivially from SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.4. We prove (a). Either hypothesis on (F, G) implies that the spectral sequence

$$E_2^{pq} = \sum_{q_1+q_2=q} \underline{\text{Tor}}_{-p}(\mathbf{H}^{q_1}(F), \mathbf{H}^{q_2}(G)) \Rightarrow \mathbf{H}^*(F \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} G)$$

is biregular. Hence one is reduced to the case where F and G are concentrated in degree 0, that is, are constructible A_X -modules. The question is local, so one may suppose X noetherian. Then F admits, by SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.7, a left resolution F' in which the F'^i are of the form $A_{U,X}$ with U étale and of finite type over X . We have

$$F \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} G \xleftarrow{\sim} F' \otimes G,$$

and the result follows since the $A_{U,X} \otimes G$ are constructible. $\square$

Notation 1.10. If X is a prescheme, we denote by $D^b(X)_{\text{torf}}$, respectively $D^b(X)_{\text{qinj}}$, the full subcategory of $D(X)$ consisting of objects of finite tor-dimension, respectively of finite quasi-injective dimension.

Proposition 1.11, cf. [H] V.2.6. Let X be a prescheme and $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$.

a) For $F, G \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$, respectively for $F \in \text{ob } D(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D^b(X)_{\text{torf}}$, there is a functorial isomorphism

$$\underline{D}_K(F \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} G) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbf{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, \underline{D}_K(G)).$$

b) If K satisfies conditions (i) and (ii) of Definition 1.7, then

$$G \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)_{\text{torf}} \implies \underline{D}_K(G) \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)_{\text{qinj}}$$

and $\underline{D}_K(G)$ satisfies condition 1.7(ii).

c) If K is dualizing, then for $F \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$, respectively for $F \in \text{ob } D(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ with $\underline{D}_K(G) \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)_{\text{torf}}$, there is a functorial isomorphism

$$\underline{D}_K(F \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} \underline{D}_K(G)) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbf{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G).$$

Moreover,

$$\underline{D}_K(G) \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)_{\text{torf}} \implies G \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)_{\text{qinj}},$$

and G satisfies condition 1.7(ii).

d) If K is dualizing and has finite injective dimension, then the implications in (b) and (c) are equivalences.

Proof. Part (a) is precisely Cartan's adjunction formula, SGA 6, I, 7.4.

For (b), let $G \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)_{\text{torf}}$. If F is a variable constructible A_X -module, then the cohomology objects of $F \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} G$ are constructible, by Lemma 1.9, and vanish outside two fixed bounds independent

of F . The same therefore holds for the cohomology objects of $\underline{D}_K(F \otimes^L G)$, and (a) gives the assertion.

For (c), the first assertion follows from (a) applied to $\underline{D}_K(G)$ in place of G , together with the reflexivity of G . The second follows by a similar argument to (b).

For (d), prove for instance the converse implication of (b). Suppose that $\underline{D}_K(G) \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)_{\text{qinj}}$ and satisfies condition 1.7(ii). Then, as F varies through constructible modules, the cohomology objects of $\underline{D}_K(F \otimes^L G)$ are constructible and vanish outside two fixed bounds. The same is consequently true for the cohomology objects of $\underline{D}_K \underline{D}_K(F \otimes^L G)$; but

$$F \otimes^L G \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_K \underline{D}_K(F \otimes^L G)$$

because K is dualizing and of finite injective dimension, cf. 1.8(d). Hence G has finite tor-dimension. The converse implication in (c) is proved analogously. $\square$

Remarks 1.11.1.

- a) The editor does not know whether assertion (d) of Proposition 1.11 is valid under the sole hypothesis that K be dualizing.
- b) One expresses the preceding proposition pictorially by saying that the dualizing functor $\underline{D}_K$ exchanges the functors $\otimes^L$ and $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}$, as well as the notions of finite tor-dimension and finite quasi-injective dimension. The exchange is, however, fully satisfactory only when K has finite injective dimension.

Proposition 1.12. Let Y be a noetherian prescheme, let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of finite type, and let $K \in \text{ob } D^+(Y)$. Suppose that n is prime to the residual characteristics of Y , and put

$$K_X = \text{R}^! f(K_Y), \quad \underline{D}_X = \underline{D}_{K_X}, \quad \underline{D}_Y = \underline{D}_{K_Y},$$

in the notation of SGA A, Exposé XVIII, 3.1.

- a) For $F \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$ there is a functorial isomorphism

$$\text{R}f_* \underline{D}_X(F) \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_Y \text{R}f_*(F). \quad (\text{i})$$

If, moreover, K_X and K_Y are dualizing,² then for $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ there is a functorial isomorphism

$$\text{R}f_! \underline{D}_X(F) \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_Y \text{R}f_*(F). \quad (\text{ii})$$

- b) For $F \in D_c^-(Y)$ there is a functorial isomorphism³

$$\text{R}^! f \underline{D}_Y(F) \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_X f^*(F). \quad (\text{i})$$

If, moreover, K_X and K_Y are dualizing, then for $F \in D_c^b(Y)$ there is a functorial isomorphism

$$f^* \underline{D}_Y F \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_X \text{R}^! f F. \quad (\text{ii})$$

²We shall see below that under fairly general conditions K_Y dualizing implies K_X dualizing.

³If the functor $\text{R}^! f$ has finite cohomological dimension, as for example when Y is of finite type over a field (SGA A, Exposé X, 4.3 and Exposé XVIII, 3.1.7), the isomorphism (b)(i) is valid for $F \in \text{ob } D_c(Y)$.

Proof. The isomorphism (a)(i) is just the duality isomorphism of SGA A, Exposé XVIII, 3.1.9.6.

The isomorphism (a)(ii) is obtained by applying $\underline{D}_Y$ to both sides of (a)(i), written with argument $\underline{D}_X F$, and using the finiteness theorem SGA A, Exposé XVII, 5.3.6, which asserts that $Rf_*(\underline{D}_X(F)) \in \text{ob } D_c(Y)$.

The isomorphism (b)(i) is the induction formula of SGA A, Exposé XVIII, 3.1.12.2.

The isomorphism (b)(ii) is obtained by applying $\underline{D}_X$ to both sides of (b)(i), written with argument $\underline{D}_Y F$, and using 1.9(b). $\square$

Scholium 1.12.1. In figurative language, the dualizing functors $\underline{D}_X$ and $\underline{D}_Y$ exchange the usual and unusual direct images, Rf_* and $Rf_!$, and also the usual and unusual inverse images, f^* and $R^!f$.

Corollary 1.13. Under the hypotheses of Proposition 1.12, suppose in addition that f is proper, and let $F \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$. If (F, K_X) is bidualizing, then (Rf_*F, K_Y) is bidualizing. Conversely, if f is finite and (Rf_*F, K_Y) is bidualizing, then (F, K_X) is bidualizing.

Proof. Suppose (F, K_X) is bidualizing. Applying Rf_* to the canonical isomorphism $F \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_X^2 F$, one obtains

$$\begin{aligned} Rf_*F &\xrightarrow{\sim} Rf_*\underline{D}_X\underline{D}_X F \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_Y Rf_*\underline{D}_X F && \text{by (a)(i)} \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_Y \underline{D}_Y Rf_*F && \text{by (a)(i).} \end{aligned}$$

The courageous reader will convince himself that the isomorphism obtained is the canonical one; this proves the first assertion.

Now suppose f finite and (f_*F, K_Y) bidualizing, since $Rf_* = f_*$ for f finite. We prove that the canonical morphism $F \rightarrow \underline{D}_X^2 F$ is an isomorphism. By Lemma 1.14(a) below, it suffices to show that the induced morphism

$$f_*F \longrightarrow f_*\underline{D}_X^2 F$$

is an isomorphism. But by applying (a)(i) twice, one convinces oneself that this morphism is precisely the canonical isomorphism

$$f_*F \longrightarrow \underline{D}_Y^2 f_*F,$$

which completes the proof. $\square$

Lemma 1.14. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a finite morphism of preschemes.

- a) For a morphism $u : F \rightarrow G$ in $D(X)$, u is an isomorphism if and only if f_*u is an isomorphism.
- b) For $F \in \text{ob } D(X)$, one has $F \in \text{ob } D_c(X)$ if and only if $f_*F \in \text{ob } D_c(Y)$.

Proof. For (a), since f_* is exact, one may restrict to the case where F and G are concentrated in degree zero. The assertion then follows immediately from the computation of the fibres of f_*F and f_*G , SGA A, Exposé VIII, 5.5.

For (b), again one may restrict to the case where F is concentrated in degree zero. Necessity is known, SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.14. We prove sufficiency: f_*F constructible implies F constructible.

The question is local upstairs, hence a fortiori downstairs, so we may suppose Y and hence X affine. By EGA IV, 17.16.6, there exists a finite family (Y_i) of affine subschemes of Y , pairwise disjoint and with union Y , such that, if $X_i = X \times_Y Y_i$, the induced morphism $f_i : X_i \rightarrow Y_i$ factors as

$$X_i \xrightarrow{u_i} X'_i \xrightarrow{v_i} Y_i,$$

where u_i is finite radicial and surjective and v_i is finite étale. Put $F|_{X_i} = F_i$. By the base-change theorem for finite morphisms, SGA A, Exposé VIII, 5.5, one has

$$f_{i*}(F_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} (f_*F)|_{Y_i},$$

and by SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.8, one is reduced to proving the assertion for (f_i, F_i) . Put $F'_i = u_{i*}(F_i)$, so that $f_{i*}(F_i) = v_{i*}(F'_i)$. It is clear from the definition of constructibility, respectively follows from SGA A, Exposé VIII, 1.1, that F_i , respectively F'_i , is constructible if and only if F'_i , respectively $v_{i*}(F'_i)$, is constructible. This proves the claim. $\square$

Corollary 1.15. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a separated quasi-finite morphism of noetherian preschemes. Let $K_Y \in \text{ob } D^+(Y)$, and put, as in Proposition 1.12,

$$K_X = R^!f(K_Y), \quad \underline{D}_X = \underline{D}_{K_X}, \quad \underline{D}_Y = \underline{D}_{K_Y}.$$

If K_Y is dualizing, then K_X is dualizing.

Proof. We already know, by Proposition 1.6, that if K_Y has finite quasi-injective dimension, then the same is true of K_X . We show that if K_Y satisfies condition (ii), respectively condition (iii), of Definition 1.7, then K_X satisfies the same condition.

By the Main Theorem, EGA IV, 8.12.6, f factors as $f = f'i$, where i is an open immersion and f' is finite. Since

$$R^!f \simeq R^!i R^!f',$$

one must treat separately the case of an open immersion and the case of a finite morphism. If f is an open immersion, the assertion is trivial, since a constructible sheaf on X is induced by a constructible sheaf on Y , and formation of $R\text{Hom}$ commutes with restriction to an open.

Suppose then that f is finite. It follows from Corollary 1.13 that if K_Y satisfies (iii), then K_X satisfies (iii), taking account of the finiteness theorem SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.14. It remains to prove that if K_Y satisfies (ii), then K_X satisfies (ii). Let $F \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$. We must show that $\underline{D}_X(F) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$. By the finiteness theorem, $f_*F \in \text{ob } D_c^-(Y)$. Hence, by the hypothesis on K_Y ,

$$\underline{D}_Y f_*F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(Y).$$

But

$$\underline{D}_Y f_*F \xrightarrow{\sim} f_*\underline{D}_X(F)$$

by Proposition 1.12(a)(i), and Lemma 1.14(b) completes the proof. $\square$

2. Uniqueness of the dualizing complex

In this section we suppose that A is local, that is,

$$A = \mathbb{Z}/\ell^\nu \mathbb{Z},$$

where ℓ is prime.

Theorem 2.1, cf. [H] V.3.1. Let X be a connected locally noetherian prescheme, and let K be a dualizing complex on X in the sense of Definition 1.7. Let also $K' \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$. Then K' is dualizing if and only if there exist an invertible A_X -module L and an integer r , necessarily determined up to unique isomorphism, such that

$$K' \xrightarrow{\sim} K \otimes^L L[r].$$

Proof. Let L be an invertible A_X -module and r an integer, and put $L^\vee = \underline{\text{Hom}}(L, A_X)$. For $F \in \text{ob } D(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ there are canonical isomorphisms

$$\text{R } \underline{\text{Hom}}(F \otimes^L L^\vee[-r], G) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{R } \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G \otimes^L L[r]) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{R } \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \otimes^L L[r]. \quad (*)$$

It follows immediately that, if $K' \simeq K \otimes^L L[r]$, then K' is dualizing.

Moreover, if we write $\underline{D}_X = \underline{D}$ and $\underline{D}_{K'} = \underline{D}'$, then for $F \in \text{ob } D(X)$ the isomorphism $(*)$ gives

$$\underline{D}'F \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}F \otimes^L L^\vee[-r].$$

Since $\underline{D}K \simeq A_X$, one obtains

$$\underline{D}'K \xrightarrow{\sim} L^\vee[-r],$$

which shows that $L^\vee[r]$, hence L and r , are determined essentially uniquely by K' .

Conversely, suppose that K' is dualizing, and put

$$P = \underline{D}'K = \underline{D}'\underline{D}A_X = \text{R } \underline{\text{Hom}}(K, K').$$

We shall prove:

- (a) $K' \xrightarrow{\sim} K \otimes^L P$,
- (b) $P \xrightarrow{\sim} L[r]$ for an invertible A_X -module L .

This will complete the proof of the theorem.

First observe that, by Proposition 1.9(b)(ii), for $F \in \text{ob } D_c(X)$ there is an isomorphism

$$F \otimes^L P \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}'\underline{D}F. \quad (**)$$

Applying $(**)$ to $F = K$ gives

$$K \otimes^L P \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}'\underline{D}K \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}'A_X = K',$$

which proves (a).

Applying $(**)$ to

$$F = P' = \underline{D}\underline{D}'A_X$$

gives

$$P' \otimes^L P = \underline{D}'\underline{D}\underline{D}\underline{D}'A_X \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}'\underline{D}'A_X \xrightarrow{\sim} A_X.$$

Thus (b) follows from the following lemma. □

Lemma 2.2, cf. [H] V.3.3. Let X be a connected locally noetherian prescheme, and let $P, P' \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$ be such that

$$P \otimes^L P' \xrightarrow{\sim} A_X.$$

Then there exist an invertible A_X -module L and an integer r such that

$$P \xrightarrow{\sim} L[r], \quad P' \xrightarrow{\sim} L^\vee[-r].$$

Proof. The proof has two steps.

First suppose that $X = \text{Spec}(k)$, with k separably closed. One merely repeats the easy proof given in [H]. The essential point is this: by EGA 0_I, 5.4.3, if M and M' are finite-type A -modules such that

$$M \otimes M' \xrightarrow{\sim} A,$$

then M and M' are invertible and $M' \simeq M^\vee$. This is where the hypothesis that A is local is used.

We now pass to the general case. By the special case just treated, for every $x \in X$ there exists an integer $r(x)$ such that

$$P_{\bar{x}} \simeq A_{\bar{x}}[r(x)], \quad P'_{\bar{x}} \simeq A_{\bar{x}}[-r(x)].$$

Equivalently, $H^i(P_{\bar{x}}) = 0$, respectively $H^i(P'_{\bar{x}}) = 0$, except for $i = -r(x)$, respectively $i = r(x)$, and the corresponding nonzero cohomology modules are isomorphic to $A_{\bar{x}}$. It remains to show that the function $x \mapsto r(x)$ is locally constant.

Assume this for the moment. Since X is connected, r is constant, say equal to r_0 . Then

$$H^i(P) = 0 \ (i \neq -r_0), \quad H^i(P') = 0 \ (i \neq r_0),$$

and

$$H^{-r_0}(P) \otimes H^{r_0}(P') \xrightarrow{\sim} A.$$

Put $L = H^{-r_0}(P)$ and $L' = H^{r_0}(P')$. Let $u : \bar{x} \rightarrow \bar{y}$ be a specialization morphism, and let

$$u^* : L_{\bar{y}} \rightarrow L_{\bar{x}}, \quad u'^* : L'_{\bar{y}} \rightarrow L'_{\bar{x}}$$

be the corresponding specialization morphisms. There is a commutative square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L_{\bar{y}} \otimes L'_{\bar{y}} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & A_{\bar{y}} \\ \downarrow u^* \otimes u'^* & & \downarrow \\ L_{\bar{x}} \otimes L'_{\bar{x}} & \xrightarrow{\sim} & A_{\bar{x}}. \end{array} \quad (*)$$

Choose a basis e , respectively f , of $L_{\bar{x}}$, respectively $L_{\bar{y}}$, and let e' , respectively f' , be the dual basis of $L'_{\bar{x}}$, respectively $L'_{\bar{y}}$, meaning that $e \otimes e'$ and $f \otimes f'$ map to 1. If $u^*(f) = \lambda e$ and $u'^*(f') = \lambda' e'$, the commutativity of $(*)$ gives $\lambda\lambda' = 1$. Hence u^* is an isomorphism, and u'^* is the contragredient isomorphism. By SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.13, it follows that L and L' are locally constant, hence of finite presentation as A_X -modules. Consequently, for every $x \in X$ the canonical map

$$\underline{\text{Hom}}(L, F)_{\bar{x}} \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(L_{\bar{x}}, F_{\bar{x}})$$

is an isomorphism for every A_X -module F . Since the geometric fibres of L are invertible, L itself is invertible. Similarly L' is invertible, and $L' \simeq L^\vee$. Hence

$$P \simeq L[-r_0], \quad P' \simeq L^\vee[r_0].$$

It remains only to prove that r is locally constant. For $m \in \mathbb{Z}$, the condition $r(x) = m$ is equivalent to

$$H^m(P')_{\bar{x}} \neq 0.$$

Thus, by SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.4, the function r is locally constructible. Therefore, to verify that it is locally constant, EGA IV, 1.10.1, allows one to suppose that X is local. Let x be its closed point and U the open complement.

We prove that r is constant. By induction on the dimension of X , we may already suppose that $r(y)$ is constant and equal to r_0 for $y \in U$; the point is to prove $r(x) = r_0$.

Assume the contrary, and derive a contradiction. By hypothesis

$$P|_U \xrightarrow{\sim} L[r_0]$$

with L an invertible A_U -module. After translating degrees we may suppose $r_0 = 0$. On the other hand $r(x) \neq 0$; write $r(x) = a > 0$. Let

$$i : U \rightarrow X, \quad j : x \rightarrow X$$

be the canonical inclusions. Consider the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow i_!(P|_U) \longrightarrow P \longrightarrow j_*j^*P \longrightarrow 0. \quad (**)$$

By hypothesis the only nonzero cohomology objects of P are $H^0(P)$ and $H^{-a}(P)$, and

$$H^0(P) \xrightarrow{\sim} i_!L.$$

It follows that $(**)$ splits naturally, via the map $P \rightarrow H^0(P)$, hence

$$P \xrightarrow{\sim} i_!(P|_U) \oplus j_*j^*P.$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} P \otimes^L P' &\xrightarrow{\sim} i_!(P|_U) \otimes^L P' \oplus j_*j^*P \otimes^L P' \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} i_!(P|_U \otimes^L P'|_U) \oplus j_*(j^*P \otimes^L j^*P') \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} i_!A_U \oplus j_*A_x, \end{aligned}$$

which is impossible, since $i_!A_U \oplus j_*A_x$ is plainly not isomorphic to A_X ; already the degree-zero cohomology sheaves are not isomorphic. This proves Lemma 2.2, and hence Theorem 2.1. $\square$

3. Existence of dualizing complexes

3.1. Preliminaries

As was said in the introduction, the object of this section is to prove that, on a “good” regular prescheme X , the sheaf A_X is dualizing, where n is assumed prime to the residual characteristics.

In fact, one would like this to hold on excellent regular preschemes of equal characteristic; but there is no doubt that the proof given below will extend to them once resolution of singularities and the purity theorem are available in that case.

We first present the various ingredients which will be used.

3.1.1. Singular locus. Let X be a prescheme, locally noetherian. We shall say that X satisfies condition *(reg)* if the following equivalent properties hold (EGA IV, 6.12.3):

- (i) for every sub-prescheme Y of X , the set $\text{Reg}(Y)$ of regular points of Y is open in Y ;
- (ii) for every closed integral sub-prescheme Y of X , the set $\text{Reg}(Y)$ contains a non-empty open subset of Y .

The condition *(reg)* is satisfied if X is locally of finite type over a complete noetherian local ring, for example over a field (EGA IV, 6.12.8), or over a Dedekind ring whose field of fractions has characteristic zero, for example over $\mathbb{Z}$ (EGA IV, 6.12.6); more generally, it is satisfied if X is excellent (EGA IV, 7.8.6).

3.1.2. Dévissage of constructible sheaves. Let X be a noetherian prescheme, and let C be a strictly full subcategory of the category $\text{Cons}(X)$ of constructible A_X -modules. Suppose that C is stable under direct factors and extensions. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) $C = \text{Cons}(X)$;
- (ii) C contains sheaves of the form $i_!(F)$, where $i : Y \rightarrow X$ is the immersion of an integral sub-prescheme and F is locally constant on Y ;
- (iii) C contains sheaves of the form $f_*i_!(A'_U)$, where $i : U \rightarrow Y$ is an open subset of an integral prescheme, $f : Y \rightarrow X$ is a finite morphism such that the generic point of Y is separable over its image, and $A' = \mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}$, for ℓ a prime divisor of n .

If X satisfies *(reg)* (3.1.1), these conditions are again equivalent to the following:

- (i bis) the analogue of (ii), with Y moreover regular;
- (ii bis) the analogue of (iii), with U regular.

If, in addition, X is affine, then in (ii), respectively in (ii bis), one may suppose Y closed in an open subset of the form $D(f)$, with $f \in \Gamma(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$.

Proof. The equivalence of (i)–(iii) was proved in SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.5 and 5.8. The remaining assertions follow by noetherian induction. $\square$

3.1.3. Cohomological dimension. Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme. We denote by $(\text{cdloc})_n$ the following condition. For every sub-prescheme Y of X , every geometric point $\bar{y}$ of Y , and every

$$f \in \Gamma(\tilde{Y}(\bar{y}), \mathcal{O}_{\tilde{Y}, \bar{y}}),$$

where $\tilde{Y}(\bar{y})$ denotes the strict localization of Y at $\bar{y}$ (SGA A, Exposé VIII, 7.1), one has

$$\text{cd}_{\mathbf{n}}(\tilde{Y}(\bar{y}) - V(f)) \leq \dim \mathcal{O}_{Y, \bar{y}} \quad (= \dim \mathcal{O}_{Y, y} \text{ by EGA IV, 6.1.3}),$$

where $\mathbf{n}$ is the set of prime divisors of n .

The condition $(\text{cdloc})_n$ is satisfied if X is locally of finite type over a field (SGA A, Exposé XIV, 3.5), or is an excellent prescheme of characteristic zero (SGA A, Exposé XIX, 6.2).⁴

3.1.4. Absolute cohomological purity. Let X be a regular prescheme, and let Y be a regular closed sub-prescheme of X , of codimension d at every point. One says that the pair (X, Y) satisfies the absolute cohomological purity theorem, relative to n , if

$$\underline{H}_Y^i(A_X) = 0 \quad (i \neq 2d),$$

and if the “local fundamental class” homomorphism (SGA 4^{1/2}, Cycle 2.2)

$$A_Y \longrightarrow \underline{H}_Y^{2d}((\mu_n)_X^{\otimes d})$$

is an isomorphism.

One says that the absolute cohomological purity theorem is true on X if every pair (U, Y) as above satisfies it, where U is an open subset of X .

Absolute purity is true on X if X is smooth over a perfect field of characteristic prime to n (SGA A, Exposé XVI, 3.9), or if X is an excellent prescheme of characteristic zero (SGA A, Exposé XIX, 3.2), or if X is regular of dimension 1 (cf. 5.1).⁵

3.1.5. Hironaka-style resolution of singularities.

- a) Let X be a regular prescheme, and let $D \geq 0$ be a divisor on X . One says that D has *strict normal crossings* if there exists a finite family $(f_i)_{i \in I}$ of elements of $\Gamma^*(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ such that

$$D = \sum_{i \in I} \text{Div}(f_i)$$

(EGA IV, 21), and such that, for every $x \in \text{Supp}(D)$, the germs $(f_i)_x$ which lie in $\mathfrak{m}_x$ form part of a regular system of parameters. One says that D has *normal crossings* if, locally for the étale topology, D has strict normal crossings.

The standard example of a normal crossings divisor is furnished by a locally finite union of coordinate hyperplanes in affine space.

- b) Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme. We shall say that X is *strongly desingularizable* if the following condition is satisfied: for every finite morphism $f : Y \rightarrow X$, where Y is integral and its generic point is separable over its image, and every regular open subset U of Y , there exists a proper birational morphism $h : Y' \rightarrow Y$, with Y' regular, such that h induces an isomorphism from $U' = h^{-1}(U)$ onto U , and $Y' - U'$ is a normal crossings divisor.

Here are cases where X is strongly desingularizable:

- a) X is excellent of characteristic zero;
- b) X is locally noetherian, regular, and of dimension ≤ 1 ;

⁴Added in 1977: or, by a recent result of G. Ofer, if X is excellent, regular, and of dimension 2.

⁵Added in 1977: or, by a recent result of G. Ofer, if X is excellent, regular, and of dimension 2.

c) X is of finite type over $\mathbb{Z}$ or over a perfect field, and of dimension ≤ 2 .⁶

3.1.6. Cohomological finiteness. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of preschemes, and let $F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$. One has $Rf_*(F) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(Y)$ in the following cases:

- a) f is proper and of finite presentation (SGA A, Exposé XIV, 1.1);
- b) “when resolution of singularities and the purity theorem are available”, in particular:
 - (i) if X and Y are locally of finite type over a field k of characteristic zero and f is a k -morphism of finite type (SGA A, Exposé XVI, 5.1);
 - (ii) if Y is excellent of characteristic zero and f is of finite type (SGA A, Exposé XIX, 5.1);
 - (iii) if X is locally of finite type over a field and $\dim(X) \leq 2$ (SGA A, Exposé XIX, 5.1).

3.2. The quasi-injective dimension of A_X

Proposition 3.2.1. Let X be a regular prescheme whose residual characteristics are prime to n . Suppose that X satisfies (reg) (3.1.1) and (cdloc) $_n$ (3.1.3), and that absolute purity is true on X (3.1.4). Then, for every constructible A_X -module F and every $x \in X$, one has

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, A_X)_x = 0 \quad \text{for } i > 2 \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x}. \quad (*)$$

Proof. The question being local, we may suppose X affine. By dévissage (3.1.2), it is enough to verify (*) for $F = i_!(G)$, where $i : Y \rightarrow X$ is the immersion of a regular integral sub-prescheme, closed in an open subset $D(f)$, $f \in A(X)$, and G is a locally constant constructible sheaf on Y . We must compute

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^q(F, A_X) = H^q(R \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, A_X)).$$

The projection formula for i (SGA A, Exposé XVIII) gives

$$R \underline{\text{Hom}}(i_! G, A_X) \xrightarrow{\sim} Ri_* R \underline{\text{Hom}}(G, R^! i(A_X)).$$

By purity,

$$R^! i(A_X) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mu_n)_Y^{\otimes d}[-2d],$$

where $d = \text{codim}(Y, X)$. Put $T = (\mu_n)_Y^{\otimes d}$. Since G is locally constant constructible, for every geometric point $\bar{y}$ of Y and every p one has

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^p(G, T)_{\bar{y}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Ext}^p(G_{\bar{y}}, T_{\bar{y}}).$$

But $T_{\bar{y}}$ is injective, being isomorphic to $A = \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. Hence $\underline{\text{Ext}}^p(G, T) = 0$ for $p \neq 0$, and

$$R \underline{\text{Hom}}(G, T) \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{\text{Hom}}(G, T).$$

⁶Added in 1977: more generally, if X is excellent noetherian of dimension ≤ 2 , by H. Hironaka, *Desingularization of excellent surfaces*, notes by B. Bennett, Bowdoin College, 1967, to be supplemented if necessary by H. Hironaka, *Certain numerical characters of singularities*, J. Math. Kyoto Univ. 10 (1970), 151–187.

Thus

$$\mathrm{R} \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(F, A_X) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{R}i_*(\mathcal{H})[-2d], \quad \mathcal{H} = \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(G, T).$$

Let Z be the schematic closure of Y in X (EGA I, 9.5.10). Then $Y = Z \cap D(f)$ (EGA 0_I, 2.1.6). Denote by $j : Y \rightarrow Z$ and $k : Z \rightarrow X$ the canonical immersions. We have $\mathrm{R}i_* = k_* \mathrm{R}j_*$, so we are reduced to computing $\mathrm{R}j_*(\mathcal{H})$. If $\bar{x}$ is a geometric point of Z , let $\tilde{Z} = \mathrm{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{Z, \bar{x}})$ be the strict localization, let $\tilde{f}$ be the image of f in $\mathcal{O}_{Z, \bar{x}}$, let $\tilde{Y} = \tilde{Z} \times_Z Y = \tilde{Z} - V(\tilde{f})$, and let $\tilde{\mathcal{H}}$ be the inverse image of $\mathcal{H}$ on $\tilde{Y}$. By SGA A, Exposé VIII, 5.2,

$$\mathrm{R}^q j_*(\mathcal{H})_{\bar{x}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{H}^q(\tilde{Y}, \tilde{\mathcal{H}}),$$

hence

$$\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^q(F, A_X)_{\bar{x}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{H}^{q-2d}(\tilde{Y}, \tilde{\mathcal{H}}).$$

The condition $(\mathrm{cdloc})_n$ implies that this group is zero for

$$q - 2d > \dim \mathcal{O}_{Z, \bar{x}}.$$

Using

$$d = \mathrm{codim}_{\bar{x}}(Z, X) \leq \dim \mathcal{O}_{X, \bar{x}}$$

(EGA IV, 5.1.3) and

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{Z, \bar{x}} = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X, \bar{x}} - \mathrm{codim}_{\bar{x}}(Z, X)$$

(EGA 0_{IV}, 16.5.12 and EGA IV, 5.1.9), one obtains

$$\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^q(F, A_X)_x = 0 \quad (q > 2 \dim \mathcal{O}_{X, x}),$$

as required. $\square$

Remark 3.2.2. The bound obtained in 3.2.1 is the best possible. Indeed, let x be a point of X , and let Y be the closed integral sub-prescheme of X whose generic point is x . Since X satisfies (reg), there exists a regular open subset U of Y containing x . By purity,

$$\underline{\mathrm{Ext}}^{2d}(A_U, A_X)|_U = (\mu_n)_U^{\otimes d},$$

where $d = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X, x} = \mathrm{codim}(Y, X)$.

Corollary 3.2.3. Let X be a regular prescheme of dimension d . If X is smooth over a field k of characteristic prime to n , or if X is excellent of characteristic zero, then X satisfies the conclusion of 3.2.1; consequently

$$\dim . q . \mathrm{inj}(A_X) \leq 2d.$$

Proof. If X is excellent of characteristic zero, or if k is perfect of characteristic prime to n and X is smooth over k , then the hypotheses of 3.2.1 are satisfied by 3.1.1, 3.1.3, and 3.1.4. The conclusion is still valid when X is smooth over an arbitrary field k , as follows immediately after the base change $\mathrm{Spec}(k') \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(k)$, where k' is a perfect closure of k (SGA A, Exposé VIII, 1.1). $\square$

Lemma 3.2.4. Let X be a prescheme satisfying the conclusion of 3.2.1 and of dimension $\leq d$. If there exists an integer N such that X has cohomological dimension $\leq N$, then

$$\dim . \mathrm{inj}(A_X) \leq 2d + N.$$

If, moreover, for every closed subset Y of X , the implication

$$\text{codim}(Y, X) \geq p \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{cd}_{\mathbf{n}}(Y) \leq N - 2p$$

holds, then

$$\dim \cdot \text{inj}(A_X) \leq N.$$

Proof. The first assertion follows immediately from 1.5. For the second, one argues as in 1.5. We are reduced to proving, for F constructible on X , the relation

$$\text{Ext}^i(X; F, A_X) = 0 \quad (i > N).$$

For this, inspect the spectral sequence

$$E_2^{pq} = H^p(X; \underline{\text{Ext}}^q(F, A_X)) \Rightarrow \text{Ext}^*(X; F, A_X).$$

By 3.2.1, the sheaves $\underline{\text{Ext}}^{2i}(F, A_X)$ and $\underline{\text{Ext}}^{2i-1}(F, A_X)$ are concentrated in codimension $\geq i$. Therefore $E_2^{p, 2i} = E_2^{p, 2i-1} = 0$ for $p > N - 2i$, by the hypothesis. Hence $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $p + q > N$, and the assertion follows. $\square$

Corollary 3.2.5. If X is a smooth prescheme of dimension d over a separably closed field k of characteristic prime to n , then

$$\dim \cdot \text{inj}(A_X) = 2d.$$

Proof. By 3.2.3 and SGA A, Exposé X, 4.2, we are in the situation of 3.2.4. The hypotheses of SGA A, Exposé X, 4.2 are satisfied by SGA A, Exposé X, 2.1 and 3.2; hence $\dim \cdot \text{inj}(A_X) \leq 2d$. The equality follows from purity: if x is a closed point of codimension d in X , then

$$\text{Ext}^{2d}(X, A_x, A_X) = H_x^{2d}(A_X) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mu_n)^{\otimes d}(k) \neq 0.$$

$\square$

3.3. Constructibility of the sheaves $\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, A_X)$

Proposition 3.3.1. Let X be a prescheme.

a) The following conditions are equivalent:

(i) for $F \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$, one has

$$\mathbf{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X);$$

(i bis) for every pair (F, G) of constructible A_X -modules, one has $\mathbf{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$, i.e. the sheaves $\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, G)$ are constructible for all i ;

(ii) for every open immersion $i : U \rightarrow X$ and every constructible A_U -module F , the sheaves $\mathbf{R}^p i_*(F)$ are constructible for all p ;

(ii bis) for every immersion $i : Y \rightarrow X$ and every constructible A_Y -module F , the sheaves $\mathbf{R}^p i_*(F)$ are constructible for all p ;

- (ii ter) for every immersion $i : Y \rightarrow X$ and every locally constant constructible A_Y -module F , the sheaves $R^p i_*(F)$ are constructible for all p ;
- (iii) for every finite morphism, respectively every closed immersion, $f : Y \rightarrow X$, and every $F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$, one has $R^! f(F) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(Y)$.

b) These conditions are satisfied in each of the following two cases:

- (i) $\dim(X) \leq 1$;
- (ii) resolution of singularities and purity are available on X in the sense of 3.1.6(b).

Proof. The equivalence of (i) and (i bis) follows from the standard spectral sequence passing from sheaf-Ext to hyper-Ext.

(i bis) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Let $\bar{F}$ be a constructible A_X -module extending F , for example $\bar{F} = i_! F$. By duality (SGA A, Exposé XVIII, 3.1.10),

$$Ri_* F = Ri_* R \underline{\text{Hom}}(A_U, i^! \bar{F}) \xrightarrow{\sim} R \underline{\text{Hom}}(i_! A_U, \bar{F}),$$

and this proves the claim.

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii bis). Factor i as a closed immersion followed by an open immersion.

(ii bis) $\Rightarrow$ (i bis). The question is local, so we may suppose X affine. By the usual dévissage (SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.5), it is enough to verify (ii) for $F = i_! M$, where $i : Y \rightarrow X$ is the immersion of a sub-prescheme and M is a locally constant constructible A_Y -module. By the projection formula (SGA A, Exposé XVIII),

$$R \underline{\text{Hom}}(i_! M, G) \xrightarrow{\sim} Ri_* R \underline{\text{Hom}}(M, Ri^! G),$$

and by a spectral sequence we are reduced to proving that

$$R \underline{\text{Hom}}(M, Ri^! G) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(Y).$$

First prove $Ri^! G \in \text{ob } D_c^+(Y)$. After factoring i , we may suppose that Y is closed. Let $j : U = X - Y$ be the complementary open immersion. Applying $R \underline{\text{Hom}}(_, G)$ to

$$0 \longrightarrow A_{U,X} \longrightarrow A_X \longrightarrow A_Y \longrightarrow 0$$

gives a distinguished triangle. Since $R \underline{\text{Hom}}(A_X, G) = G$, and

$$R \underline{\text{Hom}}(A_{U,X}, G) \xrightarrow{\sim} Rj_* j^! G$$

belongs to $D_c^+(X)$ by hypothesis, it follows that

$$R \underline{\text{Hom}}(A_Y, G) \xrightarrow{\sim} i_* Ri^! G$$

belongs to $D_c^+(X)$. Resolving M locally on Y , for the étale topology, by free A_Y -modules, another dévissage gives

$$R \underline{\text{Hom}}(M, Ri^! G) \in \text{ob } D_c^+(Y).$$

This proves the implication.

(ii bis) $\Rightarrow$ (ii ter) is trivial.

(ii ter) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Let $i : U \rightarrow X$ be an open immersion and let F be a constructible A_U -module. We must prove $Ri_*F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$. The question being local, suppose X noetherian and argue by noetherian induction on X . We may suppose $U \neq \emptyset$. Then there exists a non-empty open subset $j : V \rightarrow U$ such that j^*F is locally constant (SGA A, Exposé IX, 2.4). Let M be the mapping cylinder of

$$F \longrightarrow Rj_*j^*F.$$

Applying Ri_* gives a distinguished triangle

$$Ri_*F \longrightarrow Ri_*Rj_*j^*F \longrightarrow Ri_*M \xrightarrow{[1]}.$$

Condition (ii ter) implies

$$Ri_*Rj_*j^*F \xrightarrow{\sim} R(ij)_*j^*F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X).$$

Consequently,

$$Rj_*j^*F \xrightarrow{\sim} i^*R(ij)_*j^*F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(U).$$

Thus $M \in \text{ob } D_c^+(U)$, since $F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(U)$. Moreover, the cohomology of M is supported on a closed subset Z of U distinct from U . Applying the induction hypothesis to $U \cap \overline{Z} \rightarrow \overline{Z}$, we deduce $Ri_*M \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$, and hence $Ri_*F \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$.

The equivalence of (i)–(ii ter) with condition (iii) is left to the reader; use 1.14.

For b)(i), normalization reduces one to the case where X is regular, and one uses purity, which will be proved in 5.1. For b)(ii), see 3.1.6(b). $\square$

3.4. The biduality theorem on regular preschemes

Theorem 3.4.1, cf. [H], V, 2.2. Let X be a regular locally noetherian prescheme of finite dimension. Suppose that X is strongly desingularizable (3.1.5), satisfies (reg) (3.1.1) and (cdloc) $_n$ (3.1.3), and that absolute purity (3.1.4) is true on every prescheme smooth over X . Then A_X is dualizing.

Proof. We must prove that A_X satisfies conditions (i)–(iii) of 1.6. Condition (i) follows from 3.2.1. Condition (ii) follows from 3.3.1(b). It remains to prove condition (iii). Thus, by 1.7, for every constructible A_X -module F we must prove that the canonical homomorphism

$$F \longrightarrow \underline{D}_X \underline{D}_X F, \quad \underline{D}_X = R\underline{\text{Hom}}(\ , A_X),$$

is an isomorphism. The question being local, suppose X noetherian. By dévissage (3.1.2, iii bis), it is enough to treat sheaves

$$F = f_*i_!(A'_U),$$

where $i : U \rightarrow Y$ is the inclusion of a regular open subset of an integral prescheme, $f : Y \rightarrow X$ is finite and the generic point of Y is separable over its image, and $A' = \mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}$ for a prime divisor ℓ of n .

Because X is strongly desingularizable, there is a proper birational morphism $h : Y' \rightarrow Y$, with Y' regular, inducing an isomorphism from $U' = h^{-1}U$ to U , and such that $Y' - U'$ is a normal crossings divisor. By base change (SGA A, Exposé XVII),

$$i_!(A'_U) \xrightarrow{\sim} Rh_*i'_!(A'_{U'}),$$

where $i' : U' \rightarrow Y'$ is the inclusion. Hence, with $g = fh$,

$$f_* i_!(A'_U) \xrightarrow{\sim} f_* R h_* i'_!(A'_{U'}) \xrightarrow{\sim} R g_* i'_!(A'_{U'}).$$

By 1.11, it suffices to prove that the pair

$$(i'_!(A'_{U'}), R^! g(A_X))$$

is bidualizing. Locally immersing Y' in a prescheme X' smooth over X , and applying purity on X' , one sees that $R^! g(A_X)$ is locally isomorphic to $A_{Y'}$, up to a translation of degrees. We are therefore reduced to the following special case.

Lemma 3.4.2. Let X be a locally noetherian regular prescheme on which absolute purity is true. Let $Y = Y_1 \cup \cdots \cup Y_p$ be a strict normal crossings divisor on X , and put $U = X - Y$. Then the pair $(A'_{U,X}, A_X)$ is bidualizing.

Proof. By the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow A'_{U,X} \longrightarrow A'_X \longrightarrow A'_Y \longrightarrow 0,$$

it is equivalent to verify that (A'_Y, A_X) is bidualizing. We argue by induction on p .

If $p = 1$, let $i : Y \rightarrow X$ be the immersion. By 1.11, it is enough to verify that

$$(A'_Y, R^! i(A_X))$$

is bidualizing. By purity,

$$R^! i(A_X) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mu_n)_Y^{\otimes 1}[-2].$$

Thus the canonical homomorphism $A'_Y \rightarrow \underline{D}_Y \underline{D}_Y(A'_Y)$ is an isomorphism, as is checked trivially fibre by fibre, using Pontryagin duality for A -modules.

Suppose $p \geq 2$, and put $Y' = Y_1 \cup \cdots \cup Y_{p-1}$. We have an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow A'_{(Y-Y'),X} \longrightarrow A'_Y \longrightarrow A'_{Y'} \longrightarrow 0.$$

By the induction hypothesis, $(A'_{Y'}, A_X)$ is bidualizing. By the five lemma, we are reduced to biduality for $(A'_{(Y-Y'),X}, A_X)$. But again there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow A'_{(Y-Y'),X} \longrightarrow A'_{Y_p} \longrightarrow A'_{Y_p \cap Y'} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Since (A'_{Y_p}, A_X) is bidualizing, it remains to prove the same for $(A'_{Y_p \cap Y'}, A_X)$. Applying 1.11 again and using purity, we are finally reduced to biduality for this pair on Y_p , where the induction hypothesis applies. $\square$

This completes the proof of Theorem 3.4.1.

Corollary 3.4.3. Let S be an excellent noetherian regular prescheme of characteristic zero. Then A_S is dualizing. Moreover, if $f : X \rightarrow S$ is a morphism of finite type, then $R^! f(A_S)$ is dualizing.

Proof. The first assertion follows because S satisfies the hypotheses of 3.4.1, as recalled in 3.1. For the second, one must first verify that $R^! f(A_S)$ has finite quasi-injective dimension. Cover S by finitely many affine open subsets S_i such that $X_i = f^{-1}(S_i)$ is a finite union of affine open subsets

X_{ij} immersed as closed subschemes in preschemes X'_{ij} smooth of finite dimension over S_i . From 3.2.3 and 1.6 it follows that

$$\dim . q. \operatorname{inj}(\mathbf{R}^! f(A_S)) \leq 2 \sup \dim X'_{ij}.$$

It remains to verify conditions (ii) and (iii) of 1.7. Since these are local on X for the étale topology, we may suppose that f factors as $f = f' i$, where $f' : X' \rightarrow S$ is smooth of relative dimension d , and $i : X \rightarrow X'$ is a closed immersion. Then

$$\mathbf{R}^! f(A_S) \simeq \mathbf{R}^! i \mathbf{R}^! f'(A_S).$$

But $\mathbf{R}^! f'(A_S)$ is locally isomorphic to $A_{X'}$, up to the translation by $2d$, hence is dualizing by the first assertion. By 1.15, $\mathbf{R}^! f(A_S)$ is dualizing, and in particular satisfies conditions (ii) and (iii) of 1.7. $\square$

Corollary 3.4.4. Let k be a field, and let $f : X \rightarrow S = \operatorname{Spec}(k)$ be a morphism locally of finite type, with $\dim(X) \leq 2$. Then $\mathbf{R}^! f(A_S)$ is dualizing.

Proof. Replacing k by its perfect closure, which is harmless for the étale topology (SGA A, Exposé VIII, 1.1), we may suppose k perfect. Cover X by affine open subsets X_i of finite type over k . Since $\dim(X_i) \leq 2$, the normalization lemma makes X_i finite over a scheme X'_i smooth over S and of dimension ≤ 2 . By 1.15 this reduces us to the case where f is smooth, hence locally

$$f^!(A_S) \simeq A_X[2d].$$

Thus it remains to show that A_X is dualizing in this case; this is exactly 3.4.1, since the hypotheses are satisfied (see 3.1). $\square$

Remark 3.4.5. We shall see below that if X is regular of dimension ≤ 1 , then A_X is dualizing.

4. Local duality

The object of this section is to present the notion of “biduality” developed in the preceding sections in a form closer to geometric intuition.

4.1

Let X be a prescheme, let $i : x \rightarrow X$ be a closed point whose residue field is separably closed, and let K_X be a dualizing complex on X (1.7). We know (1.15) that $K_{\{x\}} = \mathbf{R}^! i(K_X)$ is a dualizing complex on x , hence, by (2.1) and (3.4.4), isomorphic to $A[r]$ for some $r \in \mathbb{Z}$ (if A is local). We shall say that K_X is *normalized at x* if $r = 0$ and if an isomorphism $K_{\{x\}} \xrightarrow{\sim} A$ has been given.

For example, if X is smooth of relative dimension d over the spectrum of a separably closed field, the complex $(\mu_n)_X^{\otimes d}[2d]$ is, by the purity theorem (SGA XVI 3, SGA 4^{1/2} Cycle 2.3), canonically normalized at every closed point of X .

4.2

Let X be a prescheme, $i : Y \rightarrow X$ a closed sub-prescheme, and K_X a dualizing complex on X . Then (1.15) $K_Y = R^!i(K_X)$ is a dualizing complex on Y , and one has the *complementary induction formula* (1.12 b) (ii)), for $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$,

$$(4.2.1) \quad i^* \underline{D}_X(F) \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_Y R^!i(F),$$

where $\underline{D}_X = R \underline{\text{Hom}}(_, K_X)$ and $\underline{D}_Y = R \underline{\text{Hom}}(_, K_Y)$.

Apply (4.2.1) in particular in the case where $Y = \{x\}$ is a closed point of X with separably closed residue field, K_X being normalized at x (4.1). Taking into account that A_x is injective, (4.2.1) is then written

$$(4.2.2) \quad \underline{D}_X(F)_x \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}^*(R^!i(F), A).$$

Noting that $R^!i(F)$ is also written, by definition, $R\Gamma_x(F)$, one therefore has a perfect pairing in $D(A)$:

$$(4.2.2)' \quad \underline{D}_X(F)_x \times R\Gamma_x(F) \longrightarrow A,$$

giving rise to perfect pairings between finite groups:

$$(4.2.2)'' \quad \underline{H}^i(\underline{D}_X(F))_x \times \underline{H}_x^{-i}(F) \longrightarrow A.$$

For example, let X be a prescheme smooth of dimension d over a separably closed field, and let $x \in X$ be a closed point. Then, for $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$, one has a canonical perfect duality between finite groups:

$$(4.2.2)''' \quad \text{Ext}^{2d-i}(F, \mu_n^{\otimes d})_x \times \underline{H}_x^i(F) \longrightarrow A.$$

Exercise 4.2.3

Let X be a strictly local scheme (SGA VIII 4.2), with closed point x , and let $i : x \rightarrow X$ be the canonical morphism. Let K be a dualizing complex on X , normalized at x . Denote by

$$\mathbf{L} \otimes_{i?} : D^b(A) \longrightarrow D^-(X)$$

the functor defined by

$$\mathbf{L} \otimes_{i?}(M) = M \otimes_A K.$$

(If K has finite tor-dimension over A , $\mathbf{L} \otimes_{i?}$ extends to a functor from $D^+(A)$ to $D(X)$.)

Show that there exists, for $L \in D^-(X)$ and $M \in D^b(A)$, a canonical functorial isomorphism

$$(*) \quad R \underline{\text{Hom}}(L, \mathbf{L} \otimes_{i?}(M)) \xrightarrow{\sim} R \underline{\text{Hom}}(R^!i(L), M),$$

(assuming of course that $R^!i : D^-(X) \rightarrow D^-(A)$ is defined ...).

Hint: First define a “trace” morphism $R^!i \otimes_{i?}(M) \rightarrow M$; then, to check that $(*)$ is an isomorphism, reduce by dévissage to the case where $L \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ and $M = A$, and apply (4.2.2). Note that, for $M = A$, $(*)$ reduces to the perfect pairing (“local duality”, cf. [H] V 6.2)

$$R\Gamma_x(L) \times R \underline{\text{Hom}}(L, K) \longrightarrow A,$$

or

$$\underline{H}_x^i(L) \times \text{Ext}^{-i}(L, K) \longrightarrow A.$$

4.3

We shall now generalize (4.2.2) to the case of a geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X localized at a point x which is not necessarily closed. For this we need a few preliminaries.

Lemma 4.3. Let X be a prescheme, X' the strict localization of X at a geometric point $\bar{x}$, and $f : X' \rightarrow X$ the canonical map. Then, for $F \in \text{ob } D_c^-(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$, the canonical functorial homomorphism (SGA VI I 3.7)

$$f^* \text{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \longrightarrow \text{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(f^* F, f^* G)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. As usual, one reduces to F and G concentrated in degree 0. Since the question is local in a neighborhood of x , one may suppose X affine. Then F admits (SGA IX 2.7) a left resolution by sheaves of the form $i_!(A_U)$, where $i : U \rightarrow X$ is étale of finite presentation; hence, by dévissage, one is reduced to $F = i_!(A_U)$. Form the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xleftarrow{g} & U' \\ i \uparrow & & \uparrow i' \\ X & \xleftarrow{f} & X' \end{array}$$

One has canonical isomorphisms, trivial special cases of duality (SGA XVIII 3.1.10):

$$\text{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \xleftarrow{\sim} \text{R} i_* i^* G, \quad \text{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(f^* F, f^* G) \xleftarrow{\sim} \text{R} i'_* g^* i^* G.$$

Under these isomorphisms, the canonical arrow

$$f^* \text{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \longrightarrow \text{R} \underline{\text{Hom}}(f^* F, f^* G)$$

is identified with the base-change arrow (SGA XVII)

$$f^* \text{R} i_* i^*(G) \longrightarrow \text{R} i'_* g^* i^*(G).$$

But this is an isomorphism, as one sees at once by passing to the limit (SGA VII 5.11).

Lemma 4.4. Let X be a prescheme, and let $K \in \text{ob } D_c^+(X)$ be a complex satisfying conditions (i) and (ii) of (1.7). In order that K be dualizing, it is necessary and sufficient that, for every strict localization $f : \bar{X}(\bar{x}) \rightarrow X$, $f^* K$ be dualizing.

Proof. Use the fact that every constructible sheaf on a strict localization $\bar{X}(\bar{x})$ is induced by a constructible sheaf on an étale $\bar{x}$ -pointed scheme over X (SGA IX 2.7.4), and apply (4.3).

4.5

Let X be a prescheme, $\bar{x}$ a geometric point of X , and $f : X' = \bar{X}(\bar{x}) \rightarrow X$ the corresponding strict localization.

Let Y be the integral closed sub-prescheme which is the closure of x in X ; denote by $g : \bar{x} \rightarrow Y$ and $i : Y \rightarrow X$ the canonical maps, and form the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y & \xrightarrow{i} & X \\ g \uparrow & & \uparrow f \\ \bar{x} & \xrightarrow{i'} & X' \end{array}$$

($\bar{x}$ is both the closed point of X' and the strict localization of Y at $\bar{x}$).

We shall denote by

$$\mathrm{R}\Gamma_{\bar{x}} : \mathrm{D}^+(X) \longrightarrow \mathrm{D}^+(\bar{x})$$

the functor defined by

$$(4.5.1) \quad \mathrm{R}\Gamma_{\bar{x}} = g^* \mathrm{R}^! i.$$

Using the well-known relation between the functors $\mathrm{R}^! i$ and $\mathrm{R}j_* j^*$, where $j : U \rightarrow X$ is the open complement of Y , and applying passage to the limit (SGA VII 5.11), one obtains a canonical isomorphism

$$(4.5.2) \quad \mathrm{R}\Gamma_{\bar{x}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{R}^! i' f^*.$$

When x is a closed point with separably closed residue field, the functor $\mathrm{R}\Gamma_{\bar{x}}$ coincides with the usual functor $\mathrm{R}\Gamma_x$ (SGA V 4.3), which justifies the notation.

Let $K_X \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}^+(X)$, and put $K_Y = \mathrm{R}^! j(K_X)$, $K_{X'} = f^* K_X$, and $K_{\bar{x}} = \mathrm{R}\Gamma_{\bar{x}}(K_X)$ (warning: $K_{\bar{x}}$ is not the fiber of K_X at $\bar{x}$!). Suppose that K_X is dualizing. Then, by (1.15) and (4.4), the same is true of $K_{X'}$, K_Y , and $K_{\bar{x}}$. Hence (2.1) one has $K_{\bar{x}} \simeq A[d]$ for some $d \in \mathbb{Z}$.

We shall say that K_X is *normalized at $\bar{x}$* if $d = 0$ and if an isomorphism $K_{\bar{x}} \simeq A$ has been chosen. In the case where x is closed with separably closed residue field, this recovers the notion introduced in (4.1).

Let K_X be a dualizing complex, and put $\underline{D}_X = \mathrm{R}\underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(\ , K_X)$, $\underline{D}_Y = \mathrm{R}\underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(\ , K_Y)$, etc. Let $F \in \mathrm{ob} \mathrm{D}_c^b(X)$; let us compute $(\underline{D}_X F)_{\bar{x}}$. One has:

$$\begin{aligned} (\underline{D}_X F)_{\bar{x}} &\xrightarrow{\sim} g^* i^* \underline{D}_X F \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} g^* \underline{D}_Y \mathrm{R}^! i F && \text{(by the complementary induction formula (4.2.1))} \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} g^* \mathrm{R}^! i(F) && \text{(by (4.3)), that is,} \end{aligned}$$

$$(4.5.3) \quad (\underline{D}_X F)_{\bar{x}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} \mathrm{R}\Gamma_{\bar{x}}(F).$$

Of course, one could have made an analogous computation by passing through X' instead of Y ; one would then have obtained a canonical isomorphism

$$(\underline{D}_X F)_{\bar{x}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} \mathrm{R}^! i' f^*(F),$$

compatible with (4.5.3) by means of the identification (4.5.2).

If moreover K_X is normalized at $\bar{x}$, one obtains perfect pairings generalizing (4.2.2)' and (4.2.2)":

$$(4.5.3)' \quad \mathrm{H}_Y^i(F)_{\bar{x}} \times \mathrm{R}^{-i} \Gamma_{\bar{x}}(F) \longrightarrow A,$$

$$(4.5.3)'' \quad \mathrm{H}^i(\underline{D}_X(F))_{\bar{x}} \times \mathrm{H}_{\bar{x}}^{-i}(F) \longrightarrow A,$$

where $H_{\bar{x}}^i = H^i R\Gamma_{\bar{x}}$.

Conversely, let $K_X \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ satisfy conditions (i) and (ii) of (1.7), and suppose that $K_{\bar{x}} = R\Gamma_{\bar{x}}(K_X)$ is dualizing for every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X . Then, for every $\bar{x}$, one can define (cf. 1.12 b) (ii)) a canonical arrow

$$(4.5.3)^{\text{bis}} \quad \underline{D}_X(F)_{\bar{x}} \longrightarrow \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} R\Gamma_{\bar{x}}(F) \quad (F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)).$$

If this is an isomorphism for every $\bar{x}$ and every F , then K_X is dualizing. Indeed, it remains to verify that the canonical arrow

$$F \longrightarrow \underline{D}_X \underline{D}_X(F)$$

is an isomorphism for every $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$. At an arbitrary geometric point $\bar{x}$, one has

$$\begin{aligned} F_{\bar{x}} &\xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}}(F_{\bar{x}}) && (\text{since } K_{\bar{x}} \text{ is dualizing}) \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} R\Gamma_{\bar{x}} \underline{D}_X(F) && (\text{by (4.3) and the induction formula 1.12 b) (i)}) \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}}(F)_{\bar{x}} && (\text{by hypothesis}), \end{aligned}$$

and therefore, modulo a compatibility check, (F, K_X) is bidualizing, which proves the assertion. In summary:

Proposition 4.5.4. Let X be a prescheme, and let $K_X \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ be a complex satisfying conditions (i) and (ii) of (1.7). In order that K_X be dualizing, it is necessary and sufficient that, for every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X , the complex $K_{\bar{x}}$ be dualizing and the canonical arrow $(4.5.3)^{\text{bis}}$ be an isomorphism for every $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$.

Remark 4.5.5. The existence of dualizing complexes should be regarded, in a sense, as an important complement to the global duality theorem. Indeed, the latter expresses that, for a separated morphism of finite type $f : X \rightarrow Y$ (Y quasi-compact), one has a canonical isomorphism

$$\underline{D}_Y R_! f(F) \xrightarrow{\sim} Rf_* \underline{D}_X(F)$$

(with the notation of 1.12). Its use for computing $R_! f(F)$ (when $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$) requires information about $\underline{D}_X(F)$. When K_X is dualizing, this information is supplied by the isomorphism (4.5.3), which makes possible, at least in theory, a computation of the fibers of $\underline{D}_X(F)$ as invariants of “purely spatial” cohomology.

Exercise 4.5.6. Let X be a prescheme endowed with a dualizing complex (1.7). The family of functors (cf. (4.5.3))

$$H_{\bar{x}}^i : D_c^b(X) \longrightarrow (A\text{-modules})$$

(i running through $\mathbb{Z}$ and $\bar{x}$ through the set of geometric points of X) is “conservative”, i.e. a morphism $F \rightarrow G$ in $D_c^b(X)$ such that the maps $H_{\bar{x}}^i(F) \rightarrow H_{\bar{x}}^i(G)$ are isomorphisms, is an isomorphism.

4.6

Let X be a prescheme, $j : Y \rightarrow X$ a closed sub-prescheme, and $i : \bar{x} \rightarrow Y$ a geometric point of Y . Let, on the other hand, K_X be a dualizing complex on X , normalized at $\bar{x}$ (cf. (4.5)). We saw in (4.5) that, if Y is the closure of x , one has, for $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$, a perfect pairing

$$R^! j(F)_{\bar{x}} \times \underline{D}_X(F)_{\bar{x}} \longrightarrow A.$$

It is not difficult to define an analogous pairing in the general case. Introduce the factorization of i as

$$\bar{x} \xrightarrow{i'} \{\bar{x}\} \xrightarrow{i''} Y.$$

For $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$, one has canonical isomorphisms:

$$\begin{aligned} R\Gamma_{\bar{x}} j^* \underline{D}_X(F) &\xrightarrow{\sim} R\Gamma_{\bar{x}} \underline{D}_Y R^! j(F) && \text{(complementary induction formula (4.2.1))} \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} i'^* R^! i'' \underline{D}_Y R^! j(F) && \text{(definition of } R\Gamma_{\bar{x}} \text{ (4.5.1))} \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} i'^* \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} i''^* R^! j(F) && \text{(ordinary induction (1.12 b) (i))} \\ &\xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} i'^* R^! j(F) && \text{(by 4.3)), i.e. finally a} \end{aligned}$$

canonical isomorphism

$$(4.6.1) \quad R^! j(F)_{\bar{x}} \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_{\bar{x}} R\Gamma_{\bar{x}} j^* \underline{D}_X(F),$$

and hence perfect pairings

$$(4.6.1)' \quad R^! j(F)_{\bar{x}} \times R\Gamma_{\bar{x}} j^* \underline{D}_X(F) \longrightarrow A,$$

$$(4.6.1)'' \quad H_Y^i(F)_{\bar{x}} \times H_{\bar{x}}^{-i}(\underline{D}_X(F)|Y) \longrightarrow A.$$

Example 4.6.2. Let X be a regular prescheme, let $\bar{x}$ be a geometric point of X , and put $d = \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X, \bar{x}})$. Set $K_X = (\mu_n)_X^{\otimes d}[2d]$. If X satisfies condition (reg) (3.1.1) and the purity theorem (3.1.4), then K_X is canonically normalized at $\bar{x}$. Thus, if K_X is dualizing, one has perfect pairings

$$H_Y^i(F)_{\bar{x}} \times H_{\bar{x}}^{2d-i}(F'|Y) \longrightarrow A,$$

for every closed subset Y containing x and every $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$, with $F' = R\text{Hom}(F, (\mu_n)_X^{\otimes d})$.

To finish, let us give a strictly local variant of (4.6.1).

4.7

Let X be a noetherian strictly local scheme (SGA VIII 4.2), with closed point x . Let Y be a non-empty closed subset of X , and consider the canonical immersions

$$U = X - Y \xrightarrow{i} V = X - \{x\} \xrightarrow{j} X.$$

Finally, let K_X be a dualizing complex normalized at x (4.1), giving dualizing complexes “corresponding” on U, V, Y, x (and by hypothesis $\underline{D}_x = R\text{Hom}(_, A)$):

$$K_V = j^* K_X, \quad K_U = i^* K_V, \quad K_Y = R\Gamma_Y(K_X).$$

Let $G \in \text{ob } D_c^b(U)$, and put $G' = \underline{D}_U(G)$. We propose to define a natural pairing

$$(4.7.1) \quad R\Gamma(U, G) \times R\Gamma(V, i_! G')[-1] \longrightarrow A,$$

i.e. a functorial homomorphism

$$(4.7.1)' \quad R\Gamma(U, G) \otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} R\Gamma(V, i_! G')[-1] \longrightarrow A.$$

(Since the ring $A = \mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}$ has infinite cohomological dimension for $\ell \geq 2$, one knows how to define only the tensor products

$$\mathbf{L} \otimes : D^-(A) \times D^-(A) \longrightarrow D^-(A)$$

and

$$\mathbf{L} \otimes : D(A) \times D^b(A)_{\text{torf}} \longrightarrow D(A) \quad (*).$$

We therefore leave it to the reader to make suitable hypotheses ensuring that the two factors of $\mathbf{L} \otimes$ appearing in (4.7.1)' are in $D^b(A)$, or that one of them has finite tor-dimension.)

First note that, by the complementary duality formula (1.12 a) (ii), one has a canonical isomorphism

$$(4.7.2) \quad i_!(G') \xrightarrow{\sim} \underline{D}_V(Ri_*G).$$

On the other hand, one has the ordinary duality isomorphism

$$(4.7.3) \quad R\text{Hom}(A_U, G) \xrightarrow{\sim} R\text{Hom}(A_V, Ri_*G).$$

By the definition of $\underline{D}_V$ (and independently of the fact that K_V is dualizing), one has a canonical arrow

$$(4.7.4) \quad Ri_*G \otimes^{\mathbf{L}} \underline{D}_V(Ri_*G) \longrightarrow K_V.$$

From (4.7.2), (4.7.3), and (4.7.4) one obtains a (canonical) arrow

$$(4.7.5) \quad R\Gamma(U, G) \otimes_A^{\mathbf{L}} R\Gamma(V, i_!G') \longrightarrow R\text{Hom}(A_V, K_V).$$

But $K_V = j^*K_X$, and one has the duality isomorphism (SGA 3.1.10):

$$(4.7.6) \quad R\text{Hom}(A_V, K_V) \xrightarrow{\sim} R\text{Hom}(A_{V,X}, K_X).$$

Finally, the exact sequence

$$(4.7.7) \quad 0 \longrightarrow A_{V,X} \longrightarrow A_X \longrightarrow A_x \longrightarrow 0$$

gives a homomorphism of degree +1:

$$(4.7.8) \quad R\text{Hom}(A_{V,X}, K_X) \longrightarrow R\text{Hom}(A_x, K_X) \xrightarrow{\sim} A.$$

Composing (4.7.5), (4.7.6), and (4.7.8), one obtains the announced arrow (4.7.1)'.

(*) (added in 1977) *Inexact: in fact it is easy to extend $\mathbf{L} \otimes : D^-(A) \times D^-(A) \rightarrow D^-(A)$ to $\mathbf{L} \otimes : D^-(A) \times D(A) \rightarrow D(A)$.*

We shall now see that the pairing (4.7.1) is “perfect”, i.e. that the arrow (4.7.1)' identifies $R\Gamma(V, i_!G')[-1]$ with $\underline{D}_x R\Gamma(U, G)$. Indeed suppose, as is allowed, that

$$G = (ji)^*F,$$

with $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$. Put $F' = \underline{D}_X(F)$ and $F'_{U,X} = (ji)_!G'$. One has the exact sequence

$$(4.7.9) \quad 0 \longrightarrow F'_{U,X} \longrightarrow F' \longrightarrow F'|_Y \longrightarrow 0,$$

which gives rise to a distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 & \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F'_{U,X}) & \\
 \swarrow & & \nwarrow +1 \\
 \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F'|Y) & \xrightarrow{\quad\quad\quad} & \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F')
 \end{array} \tag{b}$$

By definition of $\mathrm{R}\Gamma_x$, one has

$$\mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F'_{U,X}) = \mathrm{R}\mathrm{Hom}(A_x, F'_{U,X});$$

hence, using (4.7.7) and the fact that $(F'_{U,X})_x = \mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, F'_{U,X}) = 0$, one has a canonical isomorphism

$$\mathrm{R}\mathrm{Hom}(A_{V,X}, F'_{U,X})[1] \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F'_{U,X}).$$

But one has

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathrm{R}\mathrm{Hom}(A_{V,X}, F'_{U,X}) &= \mathrm{R}\mathrm{Hom}(j_! A_V, j_! i_! G') \\
 &\xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{R}\mathrm{Hom}(A_V, i_! G') \quad \text{by duality (SGA 3.1.10),}
 \end{aligned}$$

and hence finally a canonical isomorphism

$$(4.7.10) \quad \mathrm{R}\Gamma(V, i_! G')[-1] \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F'_{U,X}).$$

On the other hand one has the exact sequence

$$(4.7.11) \quad 0 \longrightarrow A_{U,X} \longrightarrow A_X \longrightarrow A_Y \longrightarrow 0,$$

which gives rise to a distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 & \mathrm{R}\Gamma(U, F|U) & \\
 \swarrow & & \nwarrow +1 \\
 \mathrm{R}\Gamma_Y(F) & \xrightarrow{\quad\quad\quad} & \mathrm{R}\Gamma_X(F)
 \end{array} \tag{a}$$

By virtue of (4.7.1) and (4.7.10), one has a natural pairing

$$(4.7.12) \quad \mathrm{R}\Gamma(U, F|U) \times \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F'_{U,X}) \longrightarrow A.$$

By virtue of (4.6.1), one has a perfect pairing

$$(4.7.13) \quad \mathrm{R}\Gamma_Y(F) \times \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F'|Y) \longrightarrow A.$$

Finally, by the ordinary induction formula (1.12 b) (i)), one has a perfect pairing

$$(4.7.14) \quad \mathrm{R}\Gamma(X, F) \times \mathrm{R}\Gamma_x(F') \longrightarrow A.$$

The reader who has the patience to orient himself in this maze of “canonical arrows” will check that the pairings (4.7.12), (4.7.13), and (4.7.14) are “compatible” with the arrows of the triangles (a) and (b), and consequently that the pairings (4.7.12) and (4.7.1) are perfect.

The pairing of the triangles (a) and (b) gives rise to two exact sequences “transpose to one another”:

$$(4.7.15) \quad \cdots \longrightarrow \mathrm{H}_Y^i(X, F) \longrightarrow \mathrm{H}^i(X, F) \longrightarrow \mathrm{H}^i(U, F) \longrightarrow \cdots$$

$$\cdots \longleftarrow H_x^{-i}(Y, F'|Y) \longleftarrow H_x^{-i}(X, F') \longleftarrow H_x^{-i-1}(V, F'_{U,V}) \longleftarrow \cdots.$$

In summary, we may state:

Proposition 4.7.16. Let X be a noetherian strictly local scheme, with closed point x . Let Y be a non-empty closed subset of X , let $U = X - Y$, $V = X - x$, and let $i : U \rightarrow V$ and $j : V \rightarrow X$ be the canonical inclusions. Let K_X be a dualizing complex on X normalized at x (hence giving associated dualizing complexes on V, U, Y). For $G \in \text{ob } D_c^b(U)$, one has a perfect pairing:

$$(*) \quad R\Gamma(U, G) \times R\Gamma(V, i_! G')[-1] \longrightarrow A$$

(where $G' = \underline{D}_U(G)$). If $G = F|U$, where $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$, one has a canonical isomorphism

$$(**) \quad R\Gamma(V, i_! G')[-1] \xrightarrow{\sim} R\Gamma_x(F'_{U,X})$$

(where $F' = \underline{D}_X(F)$ and $F'_{U,X} = (ji)_!(F'|U) = (ji)_!(G')$), and a perfect pairing between the distinguished triangles

$$\begin{aligned} R\Gamma_Y(F) &\longrightarrow R\Gamma(X, F) \longrightarrow R\Gamma(U, F|U) \xrightarrow{+1}, \\ R\Gamma_x(F'_{U,X}) &\longrightarrow R\Gamma_x(F') \longrightarrow R\Gamma_x(F'|Y) \xrightarrow{+1}. \end{aligned}$$

compatible with the pairing $(*)$ and the isomorphism $(**)$, and giving rise to two exact sequences transpose to one another (4.7.15).

Remark 4.7.17. In the particular case where $Y = \{x\}$, the pairing (4.7.1) is defined under the sole hypothesis that K_X is normalized at x (and not necessarily dualizing), i.e. such that $R\Gamma_x(K_X) \simeq A$ (the isomorphism being given): the isomorphism (4.7.2) (which used biduality) then reduces to the identity. Since the pairing (4.7.14) is in any case perfect, one sees therefore that local duality on X (in the form (4.2.2)') is equivalent to the “global” duality on $U = X - x$, i.e. to the assertion that the pairing (4.7.1)

$$R\Gamma(U, G) \times R\Gamma(U, G')[-1] \longrightarrow A$$

is perfect, or equivalently that the pairings

$$H^i(U, G) \times H^{-i-1}(U, G') \longrightarrow A$$

are perfect.

Suppose that one has on X a dualizing complex K_X normalized at x . If X is excellent and U is regular of dimension d (x may therefore be an isolated singularity), one should be able to check that $K_U = K_X|U$ is canonically isomorphic to $(\mu_n)_U^{\otimes d}[2d]$ (this is easily checked, at any rate, if X is the strict localization of a prescheme locally of finite type over a field of characteristic 0). Then local duality on X implies that, for every locally constant constructible A_U -module G , one has perfect pairings:

$$H^i(U, G) \times H^{2d-1-i}(U, G^\circ) \longrightarrow A,$$

where $G^\circ = \text{Hom}(G, (\mu_n)_U^{\otimes d})$, corresponding formally to Poincaré duality on a scheme of dimension $2d - 1$.

5. Local duality on curves

Theorem 5.1. Let X be a noetherian regular prescheme of dimension 1. Suppose that n is prime to the residual characteristics of X . Then the purity theorem is true on X (3.1.4), and the complex A_X is dualizing (1.7).

Proof. Suppose purity has been proved. Since X plainly satisfies condition (reg) (3.1.1), and since condition (cdloc) $_n$ is verified by (SGA X 2.2), it follows from (3.2.1) that $\dim .q.inj(A_X) = 2$. On the other hand, condition (ii) of (1.7) is verified by (3.3.1 b) (i)) (which was proved assuming purity). Hence, by (4.4), we are reduced to proving that A_X is dualizing when X is strictly local. But, to prove purity, which is a local question in a neighborhood of a closed point, one may equally well suppose X strictly local. Finally, we are reduced to proving the theorem when X is strictly local.

Thus suppose that X is strictly local. Let x be its closed point, let $(\pi = \text{car}(k(x)))$, let η be its generic point, and let $U = X - x = \text{Spec}(k(\eta))$. Let $G = \text{Gal}(k(\bar{\eta})/k(\eta))$ be the fundamental group of U . It is known [CL, Chap. IV § 2 Exer. 2] that one has a canonical exact sequence

$$(5.1.1) \quad 1 \longrightarrow P \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow H \longrightarrow 1,$$

where $H = \prod_{\ell \neq \pi} \mathbb{Z}_\ell(1)$, $\mathbb{Z}_\ell(1) = \varprojlim \mu_{\ell^\nu}$, and P is a pro- π -group. (Of course, H is isomorphic, but not canonically, to $\prod_{\ell \neq \pi} \mathbb{Z}_\ell$.)

It is also known (SGA VIII 2) that the étale cohomology of U is interpreted as the Galois cohomology of G , sheaves (respectively constructible sheaves) of A_U -modules corresponding to A -modules (respectively finite type A -modules) on which G acts continuously.

This being so, the $H_x^i(A_X)$ are determined by the exact sequence

$$(5.1.2) \quad 0 \longrightarrow H_x^0(A_X) \longrightarrow H^0(X, A_X) \longrightarrow H^0(U, A_U) \longrightarrow H_x^1(A_X) \longrightarrow 0,$$

and the isomorphisms

$$(5.1.3) \quad H_x^i(A_X) \xrightarrow{\sim} H^{i-1}(U, A_U) \quad \text{for } i \geq 2.$$

But trivially $H^0(X, A_X) = H^0(U, A_U) = A$, so $H_x^0(A_X) = H_x^1(A_X) = 0$.

On the other hand, for a Galois G - A -module M , one has the Hochschild–Serre spectral sequence

$$E_2^{pq} = H^p(H, H^q(P, M)) \implies H^{p+q}(G, M).$$

Since n is prime to π and P is a pro- π -group, one has

$$H^q(P, M) = 0 \quad \text{for } q \neq 0,$$

hence $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $q \neq 0$, giving a canonical isomorphism

$$(5.1.4) \quad H^p(G, M) \xrightarrow{\sim} H^p(H, M^P).$$

By an analogous argument, one sees moreover that $H^p(H, N)$ is identified with $H^p(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}(1), N)$ when the factor $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}(1)$ is made to act trivially on N . Thus, finally, with the preceding convention, one has a canonical isomorphism

$$(5.1.5) \quad H^p(G, M) \xrightarrow{\sim} H^p(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}(1), M^P).$$

Now the Galois cohomology of $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}$ is well known (CG chap. I p. 31): for a G - A -module N , one has

$$(5.1.6) \quad H^i(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}, N) = 0 \quad \text{for } i \geq 2, \quad H^0(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}, N) = N^{\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}}, \quad H^1(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}, N) = N_{\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}}.$$

From (5.1.3), (5.1.5), and (5.1.6) one immediately deduces that

$$H^i(U, A_U) = 0 \quad \text{for } i \geq 2,$$

and

$$H^1(U, A_U) \xrightarrow{\sim} A.$$

This last isomorphism is not canonical, since it depends on the choice of an identification of $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}(1)$ with $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}$. But, using the Kummer exact sequence, one finds (SGA XIX 1.3) a canonical isomorphism (given by the “local fundamental class”)

$$(5.1.7) \quad H^1(U, \mu_n) \xrightarrow{\sim} A.$$

Purity is therefore proved.

Let us now prove that A_X is dualizing. By (4.7.17), it is a matter of showing that, for every locally constant constructible A_U -module M , the pairing

$$(5.1.8) \quad H^i(U, M) \times H^{1-i}(U, \text{Hom}(M, A_U)) \longrightarrow H^1(U, A_U) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mu_n)_x^{\otimes -1}$$

is a perfect duality. We shall interpret this pairing in terms of Galois cohomology. We shall use the following elementary lemma.

Lemma 5.1.9. Let $D = \text{Hom}(_, A)$ denote the Pontrjagin dualizing functor on the category of finite type A -modules. Let M be a finite type A -module on which a group G acts A -linearly.

(i) One has a canonical isomorphism

$$D(M^G) \xrightarrow{\sim} (DM)_G.$$

(ii) If G is a profinite group acting continuously on M , and if G has pro-order prime to n , then the canonical arrow

$$M^G \longrightarrow M_G$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. By definition one has

$$M^G = \varprojlim_{s \in G} \text{Ker}(M \xrightarrow{s-1} M),$$

hence

$$D(M^G) \xrightarrow{\sim} \varprojlim_{s \in G} \text{Coker}(DM \xrightarrow{s-1} DM) \xrightarrow{\sim} (DM)_G,$$

which proves (i).

Let us prove (ii). Let M' be the A -module defined by the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow M' \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow M_G \longrightarrow 0.$$

One has $H^1(G, M') = 0$ because G has pro-order prime to n . The exact cohomology sequence therefore implies that the arrow $M^G \rightarrow M_G$ is an epimorphism. But, applying the functor D and taking (i) into account, one deduces that it is a monomorphism, which completes the proof.

Applying (5.1.9) to M and P , one finds that $\text{Hom}(M, A)^P$ is canonically identified with $\text{Hom}(M^P, A)$. If one chooses an isomorphism from $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}(1)$ to $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}$, the pairing (5.1.8) is written, taking (5.1.5) into account, as

$$(5.1.8)' \quad H^i(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}, M^P) \times H^{1-i}(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}, D(M^P)) \longrightarrow H^1(\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}, A) \xrightarrow{\sim} A.$$

It follows immediately from (5.1.6) and (5.1.9(i)) that (5.1.8)' is a perfect pairing. This completes the proof of (5.1).

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Appendix

by L. Illusie

The preceding theory extends easily to base Rings more general than the constant Ring $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. We shall briefly indicate how the theory is written for locally constant base Rings, killed by $n > 0$, and whose geometric fibres are noetherian rings. This is, moreover, only a provisional framework⁷: sooner or later one will have to globalize, by taking as “coefficients” on a prescheme X relative preschemes over the site $(X_{\text{ét}}, \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})$.

1. Constructible sheaves

1.1. Let X be a prescheme, and let A_X be a sheaf of rings on X (for the étale topology), locally constant, whose geometric fibres are left noetherian rings. We denote by A^X the category of left

⁷According to Grothendieck!

A_X -Modules, and by $D_A(X)$ (or $D(X)$ if there is no risk of confusion) the corresponding derived category. The notion of a constructible left A_X -Module is defined as in (SGAA IX 2.3), by replacing the expression “locally constant with value of finite presentation” by “of finite presentation as an A_U -Module”.

We denote by $D_c(X)$ the full subcategory of $D(X)$ consisting of complexes E such that $H^i(E)$ is a constructible A_X -Module for every i . It is a triangulated subcategory of $D(X)$.

1.2. Let $E \in \text{ob } D(X)$. We say (cf. Exp. II 3.11) that E is pseudo-coherent if, for every i , $H^i(E)$ is an A_X -Module of finite presentation (or locally constant constructible, if one prefers). We denote by $D(X)_{\text{coh}}$ (or $D_{\text{coh}}(X)$) the full subcategory of $D(X)$ consisting of pseudo-coherent objects. It follows from (SGAA IX 2.1) that this is a triangulated subcategory of $D_c(X)$.

Proposition 1.3 (dévissage lemma). Let X be a quasi-compact and quasi-separated prescheme (respectively a noetherian prescheme), and let C be a strictly full subcategory of the category $\text{Cons}(X)$ of constructible left A_X -Modules. Suppose that C is stable under extensions. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) $C = \text{Cons}(X)$;
- (ii) C contains the sheaves of the form $i_!(F)$, where $i : Y \rightarrow X$ is a sub-prescheme of finite presentation (respectively an integral sub-prescheme), and F is locally constant constructible on Y .

If A_X is constant with value A , a left noetherian ring killed by an integer $n > 0$, the preceding conditions are equivalent to:

- (iii) C is stable under direct factors and contains the sheaves of the form $f_*i_!(M_U)$, where $i : U \rightarrow Y$ is an open immersion (respectively an open subset of an integral prescheme), $f : Y \rightarrow X$ is a finite morphism (respectively finite and such that the generic point of Y is separable over its image), and M_U is a left A_U -Module constant with value a monogenic A -module killed by a prime divisor of n .

Finally, if X is noetherian and satisfies condition (reg) (I 3.1.1), condition (ii) (respectively (iii)) is equivalent to (i) if one further assumes Y (respectively U) regular.

Proof. The equivalence of conditions (i) and (ii) is proved as in the case where A_X is constant; see (SGAA IX 2.4 and 2.5).

Suppose that A_X is constant with value A and killed by n , and prove that (iii) implies (ii). Let $E \in \text{ob } \text{Cons}(X)$; we show that $E \in \text{ob } C$. By the equivalence (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii), we may suppose that $E = j_!F$, where $j : Z \rightarrow X$ is the immersion of a sub-prescheme of finite presentation (respectively an integral one), and F is a constructible locally constant A_Z -Module, which we may even suppose, after a little more dévissage, to be trivialized by an étale covering $g : Z' \rightarrow Z$ with group G . The sheaf F is therefore defined by a finite type A -module M on which G acts. If ℓ is a prime divisor of n , the subgroup of ℓ -torsion in M is a sub- G - A -module M_ℓ of M , and

$$M = \bigoplus_{\ell} M_\ell,$$

where ℓ runs over the set of prime divisors of n . Since C is stable under direct factors, we are reduced to the case where M is ℓ -torsion. Let H be an ℓ -Sylow subgroup of G , and let $h : U = Z'/H \rightarrow Z$

be the corresponding intermediate covering. Since the degree of h is prime to ℓ , the “trace method” (SGAA IX 5.1) shows that the adjunction map

$$F \longrightarrow h_* h^*(F)$$

is an isomorphism onto a direct factor; it is therefore enough to prove that $j_! h_* h^*(F) \in \text{ob } C$. By the “Main theorem” (EGA IV 8.12.6), there exists a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{i} & Y \\ h \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Z & \xrightarrow{j} & X, \end{array}$$

where i is an open immersion and f is finite. We have

$$j_! h_* h^*(F) \simeq f_* i_! h^*(F).$$

But $h^*(F)$ is defined by M considered as an H - A -module. Thus (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) follows from the next lemma.

Lemma 1.3.1. Let A be a left noetherian ring, ℓ a prime number, H a finite ℓ -group, and M a left H - A -module of finite type killed by ℓ^ν ($\nu \geq 1$). There exists a finite filtration of M by sub- H - A -modules such that the successive quotients are monogenic A -modules killed by ℓ , and on which H acts trivially.

Proof. The exact sequence of H - A -modules

$$0 \longrightarrow \ell M \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow M/\ell M \longrightarrow 0$$

reduces, by induction on ν , to the case where M is killed by ℓ . We show that then M has a finite filtration by sub- H - A -modules on whose successive quotients H acts trivially. Arguing by noetherian induction on the set of sub- H - A -modules of M having the stated property, we are reduced to proving that $M \neq 0$ implies $M^H \neq 0$. But the kernel of the augmentation $\mathbb{F}_\ell[H] \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_\ell$ is plainly nilpotent, and Nakayama’s lemma implies that every nonzero H - $\mathbb{F}_\ell$ -module has a nonzero invariant vector. This proves the assertion. Thus M has a finite filtration whose successive quotients are finite type A -modules killed by ℓ and on which H acts trivially. By noetherian induction one may even arrange for the successive quotients to be monogenic A -modules, completing the proof of (1.3.1).

The last assertion of (1.3) is immediate and left to the reader.

2. Quasi-injective dimension

With the notation of (1.1), one defines, as in (I 1.1 and 1.4), the notions of a quasi-injective A_X -Module and of quasi-injective dimension of an object of $D(X)$. Propositions (I 1.3, 1.5 and 1.6) extend without change.

It is sometimes convenient to introduce a notion of pointwise quasi-injective dimension. Let $x \in X$ and let $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$. We say that K has quasi-injective dimension $\leq N$ at $\bar{x}$ if, for every constructible A_X -Module F , one has

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, K)_{\bar{x}} = 0 \quad \text{for } i > N.$$

The quasi-injective dimension of K at $\bar{x}$, denoted $\dim .q.inj_{\bar{x}}(K)$, is the greatest lower bound of the N satisfying the preceding condition. Of course,

$$\dim .q.inj(K) = \sup_{\bar{x}} \dim .q.inj_{\bar{x}}(K),$$

where $\bar{x}$ runs through the set of geometric points of X .

It is interesting to compare this with the notion of strict topological dimension introduced by Verdier in [1]. We say that $K \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$ has strict topological dimension $\leq N$ at a geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X if, for every sub-prescheme Y of X ,

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(A_Y, K)_{\bar{x}} = \underline{H}_Y^i(K)_{\bar{x}} = 0 \quad \text{for } i > N.$$

The strict topological dimension of K at $\bar{x}$, denoted $\dim .top_{\bar{x}}(K)$, is the greatest lower bound of the N satisfying the preceding condition. Whereas quasi-injective dimension depends a priori on the base Ring, strict topological dimension depends only on the underlying complex of abelian sheaves.

One plainly has

$$\dim .top_{\bar{x}}(K) \leq \dim .q.inj_{\bar{x}}(K).$$

We shall see below examples where equality holds.

3. Dualizing complexes: definition and formal properties

Keep the preceding notation, but suppose A_X is commutative. The notions of bidualizing pair and dualizing complex are defined as in (I 1.7). The statements (I 1.9, 1.11, 1.14) remain valid without modification. The statements (I 1.12, 1.13, 1.15) are also valid, but on condition that A be killed by an integer $n > 0$ prime to the residual characteristics of X . Finally, the uniqueness theorem (I 2.1) is valid provided one assumes $\text{Spec}(A_{\bar{x}})$ connected for every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X .

4. Absolute purity

Return to the situation of absolute cohomological purity (I 3.1.4). Let X be a locally noetherian regular prescheme, let $n > 0$ be an integer prime to the residual characteristics of X , and let $i : Y \rightarrow X$ be a regular sub-prescheme of codimension $d > 0$ at every point. To say that the pair (Y, X) satisfies absolute cohomological purity means, recall, that the “local fundamental class” homomorphism (SGA 4^{1/2} Cycle 2.2)

$$(\mu_n^{\otimes d})_Y[-2d] \longrightarrow \text{Ri}^!(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X \quad (4.1)$$

is an isomorphism.

Now put on X a sheaf of rings A_X killed by n . For the moment set $G = (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X$. Then, for every $F \in \text{ob } D_A^+(X)$, one can define a canonical arrow in $D_A^+(X)$:

$$i^*(F) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L \text{Ri}^!(G) \longrightarrow \text{Ri}^!(F \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L G). \quad (4.2)$$

Indeed, by duality (SGAA XVIII 3.1.6), this is equivalent to defining an arrow

$$i_!(i^*(F) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L \text{Ri}^!(G)) \longrightarrow F \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L G;$$

we take this to be the composite of the Künneth arrow (SGAA XVII 5.4.2.2)

$$i_!(i^*(F) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L Ri^!(G)) \longrightarrow F \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L i_! Ri^!(G),$$

and the arrow deduced from the trace homomorphism (SGAA XVIII 3.1.6)

$$F \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L i_! Ri^!(G) \longrightarrow F \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L G.$$

Notice that in the definition of (4.2) only the fact that G and $Ri^!(G)$ have finite Tor-dimension over $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ was used. Suppose on the other hand that the functor $i^!$ has finite cohomological dimension on the category of $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X$ -Modules: this is the case, for example, if X is of finite type over a field (SGAA XIV 3.1), or more generally if X is excellent of equal characteristic (SGAA XIX 6.1) when resolution of singularities is available, or again if X is of finite type over $\text{Spec}(\mathbb{Z})$ (SGAA X 6). Then the arrow (4.2) is defined for all $F \in \text{ob } D_A^+(X)$.

Composing (4.1) and (4.2), one obtains, for $F \in \text{ob } D_A^+(X)$, a canonical arrow

$$i^*(F) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L (\mu_n^{\otimes d})_Y[-2d] \longrightarrow Ri^!(F). \quad (4.3)$$

Assume that A_X is locally constant, and let $F \in \text{ob } D_A^+(X)$ be such that every $H^i(F)$ is a locally constant A_X -Module. Then, if $i^!$ has finite cohomological dimension, the arrow (4.2), and hence the arrow (4.3) if (Y, X) satisfies purity, is an isomorphism.

Indeed, by dévissage, one first reduces to the case where F is concentrated in degree zero. Since the question is local, one may suppose X affine and A_X and F constant. Resolving F on the left by free A_X -Modules and applying the hypothesis that $i^!$ has finite cohomological dimension, one reduces to the case where F is free. By an immediate passage to the limit, one reduces to F free of finite type, and finally to $F = A_X$. It is therefore enough to prove the assertion when $A_X = (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X$. But the preceding dévissage reduces to $F = (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X$, and in that case (4.2) is the identity.

Definition 4.4. Given the Ring A_X (locally constant and killed by n), we shall say that the pair (Y, X) satisfies cohomological purity in the strong sense if, for every $F \in \text{ob } D_A^+(X)$ such that the $H^i(F)$ are locally constant, the canonical arrow (4.3) is an isomorphism.

We shall say that the purity theorem is true in the strong sense on X if, locally for the étale topology, every pair (Y, X) as above satisfies purity in the strong sense. From what has been shown, for (Y, X) to satisfy purity in the strong sense it is enough that (Y, X) satisfy ordinary purity (I 3.1.) and that the functor $i^!$ have finite cohomological dimension.

5. Bound for quasi-injective dimension

Proposition 5.1. Let X be a locally noetherian regular prescheme, equipped with a locally constant sheaf of rings A_X , killed by an integer $n > 0$ prime to the residual characteristics of X , whose geometric fibres are left noetherian rings. Suppose that X satisfies conditions (reg) (I 3.1.1) and $(\text{cdloc})_n$ (I 3.1.3), and that the purity theorem in the strong sense is true on X (4.4) (conditions all satisfied if X is smooth over a perfect field, or if X is excellent of characteristic zero).

Let $F \in \text{ob } D_A^+(X)$ be such that the $H^i(F)$ are locally constant, and let x be a point of X such that $F_{\bar{x}} \neq 0$ and $\dim .\text{inj}_{A_{\bar{x}}}(F_{\bar{x}}) < +\infty$. Then

$$\dim .\text{q.inj}_{\bar{x}}(F) = 2 \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}) + \dim .\text{inj}(F_{\bar{x}}),$$

with the notation of no. 2.

Proof. One merely repeats step by step the proof of (I 3.2.1). First show the inequality

$$\dim .q.\text{inj}_{\bar{x}}(F) \leq 2 \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}) + \dim .\text{inj}(F_{\bar{x}}) = N,$$

that is, the relation

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(E, F)_{\bar{x}} = 0 \quad \text{for } i > N \text{ and every constructible } A_X\text{-Module } E. \quad (*)$$

Since the question is local, by dévissage (1.3) one may restrict to checking (*) for $E = i_!(M)$, where $i : Y \rightarrow X$ is an integral regular sub-prescheme closed in an open $D(f)$ (with $f \in \Gamma(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$), of codimension d at every point of $D(f)$, and M is a locally constant constructible A_Y -Module ($A_Y = i^* A_X$).

Now there is the duality isomorphism (SGAA XVIII)

$$\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(i_!(M), F) \simeq \text{R}i_* \text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(M, \text{R}i^! F).$$

By the purity theorem, there is also the isomorphism (4.3)

$$i^*(F) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L (\mu_n^{\otimes d})_Y[-2d] \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{R}i^! F.$$

Let $\bar{y}$ be a geometric point of Y . Since M is locally constant constructible, one has canonically

$$\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(M, \text{R}i^! F)_{\bar{y}} \simeq \text{R Hom}(M_{\bar{y}}, (\text{R}i^! F)_{\bar{y}}),$$

hence, by (4.3),

$$\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(M, \text{R}i^! F)_{\bar{y}} \simeq \text{R Hom}(M_{\bar{y}}, F_{\bar{y}})[-2d].$$

After replacing X by a connected neighbourhood of x , one has $F_{\bar{x}} \simeq F_{\bar{y}}$ and $A_{\bar{x}} \simeq A_{\bar{y}}$, since A_X and the $H^i(F)$ are locally constant. Thus

$$\text{Ext}^i(M_{\bar{y}}, F_{\bar{y}}) = 0 \quad \text{for } i > \dim .\text{inj}(F_{\bar{x}}),$$

and hence

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^q(M, \text{R}i^! F) = 0 \quad \text{for } q > 2d + \dim .\text{inj}(F_{\bar{x}}).$$

Set $G = \text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(M, \text{R}i^! F)$ and compute $\text{R}i_*(G)_{\bar{x}}$. Introduce, as in (I 3.2.1), the schematic closure Z of Y in X , giving a cartesian diagram of immersions

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y & \longrightarrow & D(f) \\ j \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ Z & \xrightarrow{k} & X. \end{array}$$

Then $\text{R}i_*(G) \simeq k_* \text{R}j_*(G)$. Assume of course that $x \in Z$, since otherwise $\text{R}i_*(G)_{\bar{x}} = 0$. Let $\bar{Z} = \text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{Z, \bar{x}})$ be the strict localization of Z at $\bar{x}$, let $\bar{f}$ be the image of f in $\mathcal{O}_{Z, \bar{x}}$, let $\bar{Y} = \bar{Z} \times_Z Y = \bar{Z} \cap D(f)$, and let $\bar{G}$ be the inverse image of G on $\bar{Y}$. By (SGAA VIII 5.2),

$$\text{R}i_*(G)_{\bar{x}} = \text{R}j_*(G)_{\bar{x}} \simeq \text{R}\Gamma(\bar{Y}, \bar{G}).$$

Condition (cdloc) $_n$ therefore implies, by a spectral sequence argument, that

$$R^p i_*(G)_{\bar{x}} = 0 \quad \text{for } p > 2d + \dim .\text{inj}(F_{\bar{x}}) + \dim(\mathcal{O}_{Z, x}).$$

But (cf. the proof of I 3.2.1)

$$\dim(\mathcal{O}_{Z,x}) = \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}) - d \geq 0,$$

so

$$R^p i_*(G)_{\bar{x}} = 0 \quad \text{for } p > d + \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}) + \dim \text{.inj}(F_{\bar{x}}),$$

and a fortiori for $p > 2 \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}) + \dim \text{.inj}(F_{\bar{x}})$. This proves (*).

It remains to prove that the bound (*) is the best possible. Put $f = \dim \text{.inj}(F_{\bar{x}})$, and choose a finite type $A_{\bar{x}}$ -Module M' such that

$$\text{Ext}^f(M', F_{\bar{x}}) \neq 0.$$

Let Z be the integral closed sub-prescheme of X which is the closure of x , and let $Y = U \cap Z$ be a regular open subset of Z containing x and of codimension $d = \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X,x})$ at every point. After possibly shrinking Y , there exists a locally constant constructible A_Y -Module M such that $M_{\bar{x}} = M'$. Applying the purity theorem, one finds

$$\underline{\text{Ext}}^{2d+f}(M, F|U)_{\bar{x}} \simeq \text{Ext}^f(M'_{\bar{x}}, F_{\bar{x}}) \neq 0,$$

which completes the proof.

If F is an A_X -Module such that $F_{\bar{x}}$ is injective, then in the last part of the proof one may take $M = A_Y$; hence:

Corollary 5.1.1. Under the hypotheses of (5.1), suppose that F is a locally constant A_X -Module such that $F_{\bar{x}}$ is injective. Then

$$\dim \text{.q.inj}_{\bar{x}}(F) = \dim \text{.top}_{\bar{x}}(F) = 2 \dim(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}),$$

with the notation of no. 2.

Remarks 5.1.2. a) With the notation of (5.1), if $F_{\bar{x}} = 0$, then $F = 0$ in a neighbourhood of x , hence $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(E, F)_{\bar{x}} = 0$ for all $E \in \text{ob D}^-(X)$.

b) If $\dim \text{.inj}(F_{\bar{x}}) = +\infty$, then $\dim \text{.q.inj}_{\bar{x}}(F) = +\infty$; indeed, for every p there exists a finite type $A_{\bar{x}}$ -module M' such that $\text{Ext}^p(M', F_{\bar{x}}) \neq 0$, hence a constructible A_X -Module M , locally constant in a neighbourhood of x , such that $\underline{\text{Ext}}^p(M, F)_{\bar{x}} \neq 0$.

6. Constructibility of $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}$

The equivalence of conditions a) of (I 3.5.1) remains valid when the Ring $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})_X$ is replaced by a commutative Ring, locally constant, whose geometric fibres are noetherian rings: nothing has to be changed in the proof.

The preceding conditions are verified when one has resolution of singularities and purity in the strong sense (4.4), in particular if X has dimension ≤ 1 , or if X is excellent of characteristic zero, or locally of finite type over a field and of dimension ≤ 2 .

7. Existence of dualizing complexes

In this number, X denotes a prescheme equipped with a commutative sheaf of rings A_X , locally constant, whose geometric fibres are noetherian rings.

Lemma 7.1. If $F \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^-(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(X)$, then $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(X)$ (notation of (1.2)).

Proof. This is standard. One reduces, by a spectral sequence, to F and G concentrated in degree zero, and then argues as in (EGA 0_{III} 12.3.3).

Lemma 7.2. Let $g : X' \rightarrow X$ be a morphism of preschemes, and endow X' with the sheaf of rings $A_{X'} = g^*(A_X)$. Then, for $F \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^-(X)$ and $G \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$, the canonical map

$$g^* \text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, G) \longrightarrow \text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(g^* F, g^* G)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. This too is standard: one reduces by dévissage to $F = A_X$ (cf. EGA 0_{III} 12.3.5).

Remark 7.2.1. The preceding lemmas are special cases of more general statements appearing in (SGA 6 I).

Lemma 7.3. Suppose X is quasi-compact, and let $K \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(X)$ be such that, for every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X , $K_{\bar{x}}$ is a dualizing complex in the sense of [H] V 2.1. Then, for every $F \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^b(X)$, one has $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K) \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^b(X)$, and F is reflexive relative to K .

Proof. It suffices, of course, to check this for F concentrated in degree zero. By (7.1), $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K) \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(X)$. To prove boundedness, let $\bar{x}$ be a geometric point of X . By (7.2),

$$\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K)_{\bar{x}} \simeq \text{R Hom}(F_{\bar{x}}, K_{\bar{x}}).$$

Putting $\dim .\text{inj}(K_{\bar{x}}) = N(\bar{x})$, one obtains

$$\text{Ext}^i(F, K)_{\bar{x}} = 0 \quad \text{for } i > N(\bar{x}).$$

Since the sheaves $\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, K)$ are locally constant, there is an open neighbourhood U of x such that $\underline{\text{Ext}}^i(F, K)|_U = 0$ for $i > N(\bar{x})$, and quasi-compactness of X gives the assertion. It remains to check that the canonical arrow

$$F \longrightarrow \text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K), K)$$

is an isomorphism. It is enough to evaluate at a geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X . In the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F_{\bar{x}} & \longrightarrow & \text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K), K)_{\bar{x}} \\ \text{Id} \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ F_{\bar{x}} & \longrightarrow & \text{R Hom}(\text{R Hom}(F_{\bar{x}}, K_{\bar{x}}), K_{\bar{x}}), \end{array}$$

the right vertical arrow is an isomorphism by (7.2), and the bottom horizontal arrow is an isomorphism because $K_{\bar{x}}$ is dualizing; hence the top horizontal arrow is an isomorphism, q.e.d.

Lemma 7.4. Suppose X is a noetherian regular prescheme, A_X is killed by an integer $n > 0$ prime to the residual characteristics of X , and the purity theorem in the strong sense (4.4) is true on X .

Let D be a divisor with normal crossings on X (I 3.1.5 a)), and denote by $j : Y = V(D) \rightarrow X$ and $i : X - Y = U \rightarrow X$ the canonical inclusions. Let $K \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(X)$ be such that, for every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X , $K_{\bar{x}}$ is a dualizing complex for the ring $A_{\bar{x}}$ (in the sense of [H] V 2.1). Then, for every $E \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^b(X)$, one has $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(i_! i^*(E), K) \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$, and the pair $(i_! i^*(E), K)$ is bidualizing.

Proof. We may suppose E is concentrated in degree zero, i.e. a locally constant constructible A_X -Module. Since the question is local on X for the étale topology, we may suppose that (a) A_X is

constant with value A , and E is constant with value E ; and (b) D has strict normal crossings, say $D = \sum_{i \in I} \text{div}(s_i)$ with $s_i \in \Gamma(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$.

Argue by induction on $p = \text{card}(I)$. For $p = 0$, the assertions follow from (7.3). Suppose $I = \{1, \dots, p\}$, put $Y_i = V(s_i)$, $Y' = V(\sum_{1 \leq i \leq p-1} \text{div}(s_i))$, and $U' = X - Y'$. We get a cartesian diagram of immersions

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \emptyset & \longrightarrow & U' \cap Y_p & \xrightarrow{i'_p} & Y_p \\ \downarrow & & j'_p \downarrow & & \downarrow j_p \\ U & \longrightarrow & U' & \xrightarrow{i'} & X. \end{array}$$

Consider the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow E_{U,X} \longrightarrow E_{U',X} \longrightarrow E_{U' \cap Y_p, X} \longrightarrow 0.$$

By the induction hypothesis the theorem is true for $(E_{U',X}, K)$. For fixed K , the F such that $\text{R}\underline{\text{Hom}}(F, K) \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ and (F, K) is bidualizing form a triangulated subcategory of $D_c(X)$; hence we are reduced to the case $F = E_{U' \cap Y_p, X}$. But

$$E_{U' \cap Y_p, X} = j_{p*} i'_{p!}(E_{U' \cap Y_p}),$$

and, by (I 1.13), it is equivalent to prove the theorem for $(i'_{p!}(E_{U' \cap Y_p}), \text{R}j_p^!(K))$ on Y_p . By purity, however,

$$\text{R}j_p^!(K) \simeq j_p^*(K) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}}^L (\mu_n)_{Y_p}^{\otimes -1}[-2].$$

Thus $\text{R}j_p^!(K) \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(Y_p)$ and, for every geometric point $\bar{y}$ of Y_p , $(\text{R}j_p^!(K))_{\bar{y}}$ is dualizing. The induction hypothesis then applies.

Theorem 7.5. Assume the following: X is a noetherian regular prescheme; A_X is killed by an integer $n > 0$ prime to the residual characteristics of X ; X is strongly desingularizable (I 3.1.5), satisfies conditions (reg) (I 3.1.1) and (cdloc) $_n$ (I 3.1.3); and the purity theorem in the strong sense (4.4) is true on every prescheme smooth over X (conditions satisfied if X is excellent of characteristic zero, or of dimension ≤ 2 and smooth over a perfect field).

Then, if $K \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(X)$ is such that $K_{\bar{x}}$ is dualizing (in the sense of [H] V 2.1) for every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X , the complex K is dualizing.

Proof. We must show that K satisfies conditions (i) to (iii) of (I 1.7). For every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of X , $K_{\bar{x}}$ has finite injective dimension, and since $K \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(X)$, the function $x \mapsto \dim \text{inj}(K_{\bar{x}})$ is locally constant; it is therefore bounded because X is noetherian. It follows from (5.1) that K has finite quasi-injective dimension.

By what was seen in no. 6, condition (ii) of loc. cit. is also satisfied.

It remains to prove condition (iii), i.e. that every $F \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ is reflexive relative to K . By dévissage we may suppose F is concentrated in degree zero. Since the question is local on X for the étale topology, we may suppose A_X constant with value A . Dévissage (1.3) then reduces us to $F = f_* i_!(E_U)$, where $f : Y \rightarrow X$ is finite, Y is integral with generic point separable over its image, $i : U \rightarrow Y$ is a nonempty regular open, and E_U is an A_U -Module constant with value a finite type A -module E . Since X is strongly desingularizable, there exists (I 3.1.5) a projective birational morphism $h : Y' \rightarrow Y$ such that Y' is regular, h induces an isomorphism $h^{-1}(U) \rightarrow U$, and $h^{-1}(U)$

is the complement of a normal crossings divisor in Y' . Identifying $h^{-1}(U)$ with U via h , we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & Y' & & \\ & i' \swarrow & \downarrow h & \searrow g & \\ U & \xrightarrow{i} & Y & \xrightarrow{f} & X. \end{array}$$

Consequently,

$$f_*i_!(E_U) \simeq f_*Rh_*i'_!(E_U) \simeq Rg_*i'_!(E_U) \simeq Rg_*i'_!i'^*(E_{Y'}).$$

By (I 1.13), it is enough to prove biduality for the pair $(i'_!i'^*(E_{Y'}), Rg^!(K))$. But, locally embedding Y' into a prescheme X' smooth over X and applying strong purity on X' (4.4), one finds that $Rg^!(K)$ is locally isomorphic, up to degree shift, to $g^*(K)$. Hence $Rg^!(K) \in \text{ob } D_{\text{coh}}^+(Y')$ and $Rg^!(K)_{\bar{x}}$ is dualizing for every geometric point $\bar{x}$ of Y' . It remains only to apply (7.4).

The preceding proof also shows that $R\text{Hom}(F, K) \in \text{ob } D_c^b(X)$ (using the finiteness theorem for a proper morphism (SGAA XIV)), which will reassure the reader who did not trust the spiel of no. 6.

This completes the proof.

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Bibliography

- [1] Verdier, J.-L., *Dimension des espaces localement compacts*, Note aux C.R. Ac. Sc. Paris, 261, pp. 5293–5296 (1965). See also: Verdier, J.-L., *Dualité dans la cohomologie des espaces localement compacts*, Séminaire Bourbaki, no. 300, 1965–66.

SGA A = SGA 4.

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SGA 5 — Exposé III

LEFSCHETZ FORMULA

by A. Grothendieck, written up by L. Illusie

In this exposé we prove the Lefschetz formula in étale cohomology, for correspondences between complexes of sheaves, in Verdier’s formulation (cf. [18]). In an earlier version, distributed by the IHES about ten years ago, the formula was stated, under resolution hypotheses, but the required compatibilities were not proved. Deligne’s finiteness theorems (SGA 4^{1/2}, Finiteness) made it possible to dispense with these hypotheses, provided one works with schemes separated and of finite type over a field. As for the compatibilities, the editor has verified them (painfully).

Let us say at once that the Lefschetz formula in question here, just like the trace formula for constant coefficients (SGA 4^{1/2}, Cycle), which it generalizes, is essentially trivial: it only translates certain compatibilities in the formalism of duality. Roughly speaking, it says that, under certain conditions, the trace of an endomorphism of a hypercohomology complex $R\Gamma(X, L)$, where L is a complex of sheaves on X , can be calculated as an “integral” of certain cohomology classes on $X \times X$. In practice, the endomorphisms one considers are associated with correspondences $C \subset X \times X$, and the classes recovered on the product have support in $C \cap \Delta$, where Δ is the diagonal; these classes are “local in nature” in a neighbourhood of the fixed points, which in principle facilitates their calculation. See 4.2 and 4.7 for precise statements. In fact, the calculation of these “local” classes in terms of more comprehensible invariants, without which the present formula would have no interest, has so far been undertaken only in very special situations (see 4.10, 4.11, and the following exposé, where in particular the case of the Frobenius correspondence on a curve is treated).

For lack of a good derived category of ℓ -adic sheaves (Jouanolou’s thesis unfortunately not having been published), we work systematically with torsion coefficients (prime to the residual characteristics). Despite minor technical difficulties in the definition of traces, this point of view in fact leads to finer formulae, also more manageable insofar as, for the calculation of local terms, one wants to trivialize the sheaves involved by coverings (see notably (SGA 4^{1/2}, Report), III B, and XII).

In no. 1, we fix the notation and recall various Künneth formulae from (SGA 4^{1/2}, Finiteness), which play an essential role in what follows. We also introduce a certain number of fibred and cofibred categories, whose consideration later facilitates certain verifications of compatibilities. No. 2, which is very technical, may be skipped on first reading. Its main result (2.5) expresses a compatibility between external tensor product of $R\mathrm{Hom}$, direct image, and base change. In no. 3, we define cohomological correspondences between complexes, and show how they act on hypercohomology; the result quoted above makes it possible to describe this action in several equivalent ways. The core of the exposé is no. 4, where Verdier’s pairing between cohomological correspondences is defined and the Lefschetz formula is proved, in a relative situation appreciably more general than the one usually considered, with a view to later applications to computations of local terms. We give the most evident corollaries for correspondences with constant coefficients. In no. 5, we indicate rapidly how to generalize to correspondences between complexes certain usual constructions on correspondences with constant coefficients (cf. [12]), such as passage to the dual, composition, and external tensor product. Most of the verifications, analogous to those in the preceding numbers, have been omitted. Finally, in the appendix, we paraphrase the preceding theory in the context of coherent sheaves, using the formalism of duality of [8]. Here one may work over any noetherian base S , provided that, when necessary, one imposes hypotheses of properness, finite tor-dimension, and tor-independence on the S -schemes considered. We show that the very general Lefschetz formula thereby obtained contains as a special case the Woods Hole formula [1], and we point out some applications.

Contents

1. Notation and recalls of Künneth formulae.
2. Functoriality of RHom and external tensor products.
3. Cohomological correspondences.
4. Pairings of correspondences. Lefschetz formula.
5. Complements.
6. Appendix. Lefschetz formula for coherent sheaves.

2 Notation and recalls of Künneth formulae

1.1

We denote by S the spectrum of a field. Unless otherwise stated, the S -schemes considered in what follows will be S -schemes separated and of finite type.

We denote by A a commutative noetherian ring, annihilated by an integer invertible on S . If X is an S -scheme, we denote by $D(X) = D(X, A)$ the derived category of complexes of A -modules on X (for the étale topology), and by $D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X)$ the full subcategory consisting of complexes of finite tor-dimension, with constructible cohomology. The category $D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X)$ is a triangulated subcategory of $D(X)$. If $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X)$, it follows readily from the definitions that $E \otimes^L F \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X)$. According to (SGA 4^{1/2}, Finiteness Theorem 1.6, 1.7), one also has $\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X)$.

1.2

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be an S -morphism. One has trivially

$$f^* D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(Y) \subset D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X),$$

and, by (loc. cit.),

$$Rf_* D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X) \subset D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(Y), \quad Rf_! D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X) \subset D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(Y), \quad Rf^! D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(Y) \subset D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X),$$

(the inclusion relative to $Rf_!$ uses only the finiteness theorem for proper morphisms (SGA 4 XIV) and the sorites (SGA 4 XVII 5.2.11), and hence holds more generally for every compactifiable morphism whose fibres have bounded dimension). In what follows, we shall sometimes write f_* , $f_!$, $f^!$ instead of Rf_* , $Rf_!$, $Rf^!$; the hypotheses of 1.1 imply that these functors are defined on the whole derived category.

1.3

For $f : X \rightarrow S$, we shall put

$$K_X = f^! A,$$

and shall denote by D_X (or D) the functor $\mathrm{RHom}(-, K_X)$. According to (SGA 4^{1/2}, Finiteness Theorem 4.3), the complex K_X is dualizing: for $E \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X)$, one has canonically

$$E \xrightarrow{\sim} DDE.$$

1.4

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be an S -morphism, $L \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $M \in \text{ob } D(Y)$. We put

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Hom}_f^{(1)}(L, M) &= \text{Hom}(f^*M, L) \quad (\simeq \text{Hom}(M, f_*L)), \\ \text{Hom}_f^{(2)}(L, M) &= \text{Hom}(L, f^*M), \\ \text{Hom}_f^{(3)}(L, M) &= \text{Hom}(f_!L, M) \quad (\simeq \text{Hom}(L, f^!M)), \\ \text{Hom}_f^{(4)}(L, M) &= \text{Hom}(f^!M, L).\end{aligned}$$

The elements of $\text{Hom}_f^{(i)}(L, M)$ will be called *arrows of type i from L to M over f* (or f -arrows of type i from L to M). The transitivity isomorphisms for the functors f^* , f_* , $f_!$, $f^!$ allow one to compose arrows of type i for fixed i , and one thus obtains certain fibred or cofibred categories over the category of S -schemes: for example, for $i = 1$ (resp. $i = 3$) one obtains the fibred and cofibred category considered in (SGA 4 XVII 4.1.3) (resp. (SGA 4 XVIII 3.1.13)), whose fibre over X is the category opposite to $D(X)$ (resp. $D(X)$).

1.5

Let, for $i = 1, 2$, X_i be an S -scheme, $X = X_1 \times_S X_2$, and $L_i \in \text{ob } D^-(X_i)$. We put

$$L_1 \otimes_S^L L_2 = \text{pr}_1^* L_1 \otimes^L \text{pr}_2^* L_2,$$

where $\text{pr}_i : X \rightarrow X_i$ is the canonical projection.

1.6

Let, for $i = 1, 2$, $f_i : X_i \rightarrow Y_i$ be an S -morphism,

$$f = f_1 \times_S f_2 : X = X_1 \times_S X_2 \rightarrow Y = Y_1 \times_S Y_2,$$

$L_i \in \text{ob } D^-(X_i)$, $M_i \in \text{ob } D^-(Y_i)$. The evident canonical isomorphism

$$f_1^* M_1 \otimes_S^L f_2^* M_2 \xrightarrow{\sim} f^*(M_1 \otimes_S^L M_2) \quad (1.6.1)$$

allows one to define, for $u_i \in \text{Hom}_{f_i}^{(1)}(L_i, M_i)$ (resp. $\text{Hom}_{f_i}^{(2)}(L_i, M_i)$),

$$u_1 \otimes_S^L u_2 \in \text{Hom}_f^{(1)}(L, M) \quad (\text{resp. } \text{Hom}_f^{(2)}(L, M)), \quad (1.6.2)$$

where $L = L_1 \otimes_S^L L_2$, $M = M_1 \otimes_S^L M_2$. If u_i, v_i are composable, one has

$$(v_1 u_1) \otimes_S^L (v_2 u_2) = (v_1 \otimes_S^L v_2)(u_1 \otimes_S^L u_2). \quad (1.6.3)$$

Taking $M_i = f_{i*} L_i$, and u_i of type 1, given by the identity of $f_{i*} L_i$, 1.6.2 gives a *Künneth arrow* (cf. SGA 4 XVII 5.4.1.4)

$$f_{1*} L_1 \otimes_S^L f_{2*} L_2 \longrightarrow f_*(L_1 \otimes_S^L L_2). \quad (1.6.4)$$

According to (SGA 4^{1/2}, Finiteness Theorem 1.9), 1.6.4 is an isomorphism: by 1.6.3 one is indeed reduced to the case where $X_2 = Y_2$, $f_2 = 1$, and one applies (loc. cit. App.). When f_1 and f_2 are proper, it is not necessary to invoke (loc. cit.): 1.6.4 is a special case of the Künneth isomorphism (SGA 4 XVII 5.4.3).

1.7

Choose a compactification $f_i = p_i j_i$, where j_i is an open immersion and p_i is a proper morphism. Composing the evident canonical isomorphism (where $j = j_1 \times_S j_2$)

$$j_{1!} L_1 \otimes_S^L j_{2!} L_2 \xrightarrow{\sim} j_!(L_1 \otimes_S^L L_2)$$

with the isomorphism 1.6.4 relative to $(p_i, j_i! L_i)$, one obtains a Künneth isomorphism (SGA 4 XVII 5.4.3)

$$f_{1!} L_1 \otimes_S^L f_{2!} L_2 \xrightarrow{\sim} f_!(L_1 \otimes_S^L L_2). \quad (1.7.1)$$

One checks easily (loc. cit.) that 1.7.1 does not depend on the compactifications chosen, and is compatible with the transitivity isomorphisms for composites $g_i f_i$ (cf. (loc. cit. 5.2.4)). Thanks to 1.7.1, one can define, for $u_i \in \mathrm{Hom}_{f_i}^{(3)}(L_i, M_i)$,

$$u_1 \otimes_S^L u_2 \in \mathrm{Hom}_f^{(3)}(L, M) \quad (1.7.2)$$

with L and M as in 1.6.2, and one has a transitivity formula analogous to 1.6.3.

For $L_i = f_i^! M_i$, and u_i given by the identity of L_i , 1.7.2 gives a Künneth arrow

$$f_1^! M_1 \otimes_S^L f_2^! M_2 \longrightarrow f^!(M_1 \otimes_S^L M_2). \quad (1.7.3)$$

Proposition 1.7.4

The arrow 1.7.3 is an isomorphism.

By the transitivity formula, it suffices to treat the case where $X_2 = Y_2$, $f_2 = 1$. By dévissage, one reduces to $M_2 = g_* j_! A_V$, where $j : V \rightarrow U$ is an open immersion and $g : U \rightarrow Y_2$ a finite morphism, and then, by (SGA 4 XVIII 3.1.12.3), to the case where $M_2 = A_{Y_2}$. By localization on X_2 , one may suppose moreover that $f_1 = g_1 j_1$, where j_1 is a closed immersion and g_1 a smooth morphism purely of relative dimension n_1 . By transitivity, it suffices to treat the cases

$$\text{a) } f_1 = g_1, \quad \text{b) } f_1 = j_1.$$

In case a), the trace morphism supplies by adjunction (SGA 4 XVIII 3.2.5) an isomorphism

$$f_1^* M_1(n_1)[2n_1] \xrightarrow{\sim} f_1^! M_1;$$

this is compatible with the base change $Y_2 \rightarrow S$, because the trace morphism is so (SGA 4 XVIII 2.9), whence 1.7.4 in this case. In case b), if i_1 denotes the inclusion of the complementary open, one has an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow j_{1*} Rj_1^! M_1 \longrightarrow M_1 \longrightarrow Ri_{1*} i_1^* M_1 \longrightarrow 0,$$

and the compatibility of Ri_{1*} with base change, a special case of 1.6.4, gives the conclusion.

Thanks to 1.7.3, one can define, for $u_i \in \mathrm{Hom}_{f_i}^{(4)}(L_i, M_i)$,

$$u_1 \otimes_S^L u_2 \in \mathrm{Hom}_f^{(4)}(L, M) \quad (1.7.5)$$

(L and M as in 1.6.2), with a transitivity formula analogous to 1.6.3.

On the other hand, with the notation of 1.3, 1.7.3 gives an isomorphism

$$K_{X_1} \otimes_S^L K_{X_2} \xrightarrow{\sim} K_X. \quad (1.7.6)$$

1.8

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be an S -morphism, $L \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $M \in \text{ob } D(Y)$, S' an S -scheme, $P \in \text{ob } D(S')$, and $f' : X' \rightarrow Y'$ the morphism deduced from f by the base change $S' \rightarrow S$. The identity arrow of P may be regarded indifferently as an arrow of type i ($1 \leq i \leq 4$) over the identity arrow of S' ; for $u \in \text{Hom}_f^{(i)}(L, M)$ ($1 \leq i \leq 4$), one may therefore, by 1.6.2, 1.7.2, 1.7.5, consider

$$u \otimes_S^L \text{Id}_P \in \text{Hom}_{f'}^{(i)}(L \otimes_S^L P, M \otimes_S^L P). \quad (1.8.1)$$

We shall sometimes write $u \otimes_S^L P$ instead of $u \otimes_S^L \text{Id}_P$.

3 Functoriality of RHom and external tensor products

2.1

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be an S -morphism, $P \in \text{ob } D(Y)$, $Q \in \text{ob } D^+(Y)$. The evident canonical arrow at the level of complexes

$$f^* \mathcal{H}om^\bullet(P, Q) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}om^\bullet(f^* P, f^* Q)$$

gives by derivation a canonical arrow

$$f^* \text{RHom}(P, Q) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(f^* P, f^* Q). \quad (2.1.1)$$

Let $L \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $M \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$. Put

$$\text{Hom}_f^{(i,j)}((L, M), (P, Q)) = \text{Hom}_f^{(i)}(L, P) \times \text{Hom}_f^{(j)}(M, Q), \quad (2.1.2)$$

with the notation of 1.4. For $(u, v) \in \text{Hom}_f^{(2,1)}((L, M), (P, Q))$ one defines

$$\text{RHom}(u, v) \in \text{Hom}_f^{(1)}(\text{RHom}(L, M), \text{RHom}(P, Q)) \quad (2.1.3)$$

by composing 2.1.1 with the arrow $\text{RHom}(f^* P, f^* Q) \rightarrow \text{RHom}(L, M)$ defined by u and v . For $L = f^* P$, $Q = f_* M$, u (resp. v) given by the identity of L (resp. Q), $\text{RHom}(u, v)$ is the “trivial duality” isomorphism

$$\text{RHom}(P, f_* M) \xrightarrow{\sim} f_* \text{RHom}(f^* P, M). \quad (2.1.4)$$

For $(u, v) \in \text{Hom}_f^{(3,4)}((L, M), (P, Q))$, one defines

$$\text{RHom}(u, v) \in \text{Hom}_f^{(1)}(\text{RHom}(L, M), \text{RHom}(P, Q)) \quad (2.1.5)$$

as the composite of the arrows

$$\text{RHom}(P, Q) \xrightarrow{a} \text{RHom}(f_! L, Q) \xrightarrow{b} f_* \text{RHom}(L, f^! Q) \xrightarrow{c} f_* \text{RHom}(L, M),$$

where a (resp. c) is defined by u (resp. v), and b is the inverse of the duality isomorphism (SGA 4 XVIII 3.1.9.6).

It follows easily from the definitions that the formation of $\text{RHom}(u, v)$ is compatible with composition: for composable (u, v) , (u', v') of type $(2, 1)$ (resp. $(3, 4)$), one has

$$\text{RHom}(u' u, v' v) = \text{RHom}(u', v') \text{RHom}(u, v). \quad (2.1.6)$$

2.2

Let X be an S -scheme. Recall that for $L \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$, $M \in \text{ob } D(X)$, $N \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$, one has the adjunction isomorphism (“dear to Cartan,” as Grothendieck says)

$$\text{Hom}(L \otimes^L M, N) = \text{Hom}(L, \text{RHom}(M, N)). \quad (2.2.1)$$

For $E \in \text{ob } D^-(X)$, $F \in \text{ob } D^+(X)$, the identity arrow of $\text{RHom}(E, F)$ defines via 2.2.1 an arrow

$$E \otimes^L \text{RHom}(E, F) \longrightarrow F, \quad (2.2.2)$$

called the *evaluation arrow*: it is derived from the arrow at the level of complexes

$$\text{Hom}^\bullet(E, F) \otimes E \longrightarrow F, \quad f \otimes x \longmapsto f(x).$$

Let, for $i = 1, 2$, $E_i, F_i \in \text{ob } D_{\text{ctf}}(X)$. By adjunction (2.2.1), the arrow

$$E_1 \otimes^L E_2 \otimes \text{RHom}(E_1, F_1) \otimes \text{RHom}(E_2, F_2) \longrightarrow F_1 \otimes^L F_2,$$

composed of a symmetry isomorphism and of the tensor product of the evaluation arrows relative to (E_1, F_1) and (E_2, F_2) , supplies an arrow

$$\text{RHom}(E_1, F_1) \otimes \text{RHom}(E_2, F_2) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(E_1 \otimes^L E_2, F_1 \otimes^L F_2). \quad (2.2.3)$$

Let, for $i = 1, 2$, X_i be an S -scheme, $X = X_1 \times_S X_2$, $p_i : X \rightarrow X_i$ the canonical projection, $E_i, F_i \in \text{ob } D_{\text{ctf}}(X_i)$, $E = E_1 \otimes_S^L E_2$, $F = F_1 \otimes_S^L F_2$. One has a canonical arrow

$$\text{RHom}(E_1, F_1) \otimes_S^L \text{RHom}(E_2, F_2) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(E, F), \quad (2.2.4)$$

obtained by composing the tensor product of the arrows $p_i^* \text{RHom}(E_i, F_i) \rightarrow \text{RHom}(p_i^* E_i, p_i^* F_i)$ and 2.2.3 for $(p_i^* E_i, p_i^* F_i)$.

Proposition 2.3

The arrow 2.2.4 is an isomorphism.

By localization and dévissage, one reduces to $E_i = f_{i!} A_{U_i}$ for $f_i : U_i \rightarrow X_i$ étale. One has canonical isomorphisms (duality)

$$\text{RHom}(f_{i!} A_{U_i}, F_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} f_{i*} f_i^* F_i, \quad \text{RHom}(E, F) \xrightarrow{\sim} f_* f^* F \quad (f = f_1 \times_S f_2). \quad (1)$$

Taking into account the Künneth formula 1.6.4, it suffices, to conclude, to verify that these isomorphisms make the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{RHom}(f_{1!} A_{U_1}, F_1) \otimes_S^L \text{RHom}(f_{2!} A_{U_2}, F_2) & \xrightarrow{2.2.3} & \text{RHom}(f_! A_U, F) \\ \sim \downarrow & & \downarrow \sim \\ f_{1*} f_1^* F_1 \otimes_S^L f_{2*} f_2^* F_2 & \xrightarrow{1.6.4} & f_* f^* F \end{array}$$

commute, where $U = U_1 \times_S U_2$. Since f_i is étale, the isomorphism (1) relative to f_i (resp. f) is adjoint to the composite arrow

$$f_i^* \text{RHom}(f_{i!} A_{U_i}, F_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{RHom}(f_i^* f_{i!} A_{U_i}, f_i^* F_i) \longrightarrow f_i^* F_i, \quad (3)$$

where the second arrow is deduced from the adjunction $A_{U_i} \rightarrow f_i^* f_{i!} A_{U_i}$ (resp. the analogous composite arrow with f). The commutativity of (2) is equivalent to that of the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f_1^* \mathrm{RHom}(f_{1!} A_{U_1}, F_1) \otimes_S^L f_2^* \mathrm{RHom}(f_{2!} A_{U_2}, F_2) & \longrightarrow & f^* \mathrm{RHom}(f_! A_U, F) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ f_1^* F_1 \otimes_S^L f_2^* F_2 & \xrightarrow{\sim} & f^* F, \end{array}$$

where the vertical arrows are given by (3). But the commutativity of this square follows from the fact that 2.2.3 is functorial in E_i and reduces to the identity for $E_i = A$, whence the proposition.

2.4

Let, for $i = 1, 2$, $f_i : X_i \rightarrow Y_i$ be an S -morphism,

$$f = f_1 \times_S f_2 : X \rightarrow Y,$$

$E_i, F_i \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X_i)$, $P_i, Q_i \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(Y_i)$,

$$E = E_1 \otimes_S^L E_2, \quad F = F_1 \otimes_S^L F_2, \quad P = P_1 \otimes_S^L P_2, \quad Q = Q_1 \otimes_S^L Q_2.$$

Consider the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} (E_1, F_1) & & X_1 \longleftarrow X_1 \times_S Y_2 \longleftarrow X & & (E, F) \\ \downarrow f_1 & & \downarrow & \swarrow f & \downarrow \\ (P_1, Q_1) & & Y_1 \longleftarrow Y \longleftarrow Y_1 \times_S X_2 & & \\ & & \downarrow & \swarrow & \downarrow \\ S \longleftarrow Y_2 \longleftarrow X_2 & & f_2 & & (E_2, F_2). \end{array} \quad (2.4.0)$$

Give ourselves $(u_1, v_1) \in \mathrm{Hom}_{f_1}^{(3,4)}((E_1, F_1), (P_1, Q_1))$, $(u_2, v_2) \in \mathrm{Hom}_{f_2}^{(2,1)}((E_2, F_2), (P_2, Q_2))$ (notation of 2.1.2 and 1.4). By 1.8, one deduces from (u_i, v_i) a square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (E, F) & \xleftarrow{(E_1 \otimes_S^L u_2, F_1 \otimes_S^L v_2)} & (E_1 \otimes_S^L P_2, F_1 \otimes_S^L Q_2) \\ \downarrow (u_1 \otimes_S^L E_2, v_1 \otimes_S^L F_2) & & \downarrow (u_1 \otimes_S^L P_2, v_1 \otimes_S^L Q_2) \\ (P_1 \otimes_S^L E_2, Q_1 \otimes_S^L F_2) & \xrightarrow{(P_1 \otimes_S^L u_2, Q_1 \otimes_S^L v_2)} & (P, Q), \end{array} \quad (2.4.1)$$

where the vertical arrows (resp. horizontal arrows) are of type $(3, 4)$ (resp. $(2, 1)$).

We may now state the main compatibility of this number, which will play an essential role in the verification of the Lefschetz–Verdier formula.

Proposition 2.5

The diagram 2.5.1 below, where the square on the right is deduced from 2.4.1 by applying RHom in the sense of 2.1.3 and 2.1.5, is commutative:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 \mathrm{RHom}(E_1, F_1) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(E_2, F_2) & \xrightarrow{2.2.4} & \mathrm{RHom}(E, F) & & \\
 \downarrow & & \searrow & & \\
 \mathrm{RHom}(u_1, v_1) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(u_2, v_2) & & & & \mathrm{RHom}(E_1 \otimes_S^L P_2, F_1 \otimes_S^L Q_2) \\
 \downarrow & & & & \downarrow \\
 \mathrm{RHom}(P_1, Q_1) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P_2, Q_2) & \xleftarrow{2.2.4} & \mathrm{RHom}(P, Q) & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \mathrm{RHom}(P_1 \otimes_S^L E_2, Q_1 \otimes_S^L F_2)
 \end{array} \tag{2.5.1}$$

2.6

The proof of 2.5 will occupy the rest of no. 2. It follows from 1.6.3 that, if $w_i : L_i \rightarrow M_i$ is an arrow of type 1 over f_i , the arrow $w = w_1 \otimes_S^L w_2$ makes the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 & L_1 \otimes_S^L L_2 & \\
 L_1 \otimes_S^L w_2 \swarrow & & \searrow w_1 \otimes_S^L L_2 \\
 L_1 \otimes_S^L M_2 & & M_1 \otimes_S^L L_2 \\
 w_1 \otimes_S^L M_2 \searrow & & \swarrow M_1 \otimes_S^L w_2 \\
 & M_1 \otimes_S^L M_2 &
 \end{array}$$

commute. Applying this remark to $w_i = \mathrm{RHom}(u_i, v_i)$, one sees that it suffices to prove the following special cases of 2.5.

Corollary 2.6.1

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be an S -morphism, S' an S -scheme, $f' : X' \rightarrow Y'$ the morphism deduced from f by the base change $S' \rightarrow S$, $E, F \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(X)$, $P, Q \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(Y)$, $P', Q' \in \mathrm{ob} D_{\mathrm{ctf}}(S')$, and $(u, v) \in \mathrm{Hom}_f^{(2,1)}((E, F), (P, Q))$ (resp. $\mathrm{Hom}_f^{(3,4)}((E, F), (P, Q))$). Then one has a commutative square, whose vertical arrows are of type 1 over f' :

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{2.2.4} & \mathrm{RHom}(E \otimes_S^L P', F \otimes_S^L Q') \\
 \mathrm{RHom}(u, v) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') \downarrow & & \downarrow \mathrm{RHom}(u \otimes_S^L P', v \otimes_S^L Q') \\
 \mathrm{RHom}(P, Q) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{2.2.4} & \mathrm{RHom}(P \otimes_S^L P', Q \otimes_S^L Q').
 \end{array} \tag{2.6.1.1}$$

First examine the case where (u, v) is of type (2, 1). By functoriality, one may suppose that $E = f^*P$, $F = f^*Q$, (u, v) being given by the identity of (f^*P, f^*Q) . The commutativity of 2.6.1.1 in the case

$P' = Q' = A_{S'}$ is evident; to establish it in the general case, it therefore suffices to verify that, for $L, M \in \text{ob } D_{\text{ctf}}(Y)$, the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f^* \text{RHom}(E, F) \otimes^L f^* \text{RHom}(L, M) & \xrightarrow{f^*(2.2.3)} & f^* \text{RHom}(E \otimes^L L, F \otimes^L M) \\ \downarrow 2.1.1 \otimes 2.1.1 & & \downarrow 2.1.1 \\ \text{RHom}(f^* E, f^* F) \otimes^L \text{RHom}(f^* L, f^* M) & \xrightarrow{2.2.3} & \text{RHom}(f^*(E \otimes^L L), f^*(F \otimes^L M)) \end{array}$$

is commutative. But one sees immediately that the two composites of this square are adjoint to the tensor product of the evaluation arrows

$$f^* E \otimes^L f^* \text{RHom}(E, F) \longrightarrow f^* F \quad \text{and} \quad f^* L \otimes^L f^* \text{RHom}(L, M) \longrightarrow f^* M,$$

which proves the assertion.

Now pass to the case where (u, v) is of type $(3, 4)$. By functoriality, one may suppose that $P = f_! E$, $F = f^! Q$, (u, v) being defined by $(\text{Id}_P, \text{Id}_F)$. One must prove the commutativity of the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f_* \text{RHom}(E, f^! Q) \otimes_S^L \text{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{b} & f'_* \text{RHom}(E \otimes_S^L P', f^! Q \otimes_S^L Q') \\ \downarrow a \otimes \text{RHom}(P', Q') & & \downarrow a' \\ \text{RHom}(f_! E, Q) \otimes_S^L \text{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{2.2.4} & \text{RHom}(f_! E \otimes_S^L P', Q \otimes_S^L Q'), \end{array}$$

where b is the composite of $f'_*(2.2.4)$ and a base-change isomorphism, a is the duality isomorphism (SGA 4 XVIII 3.1.9.6), and a' is the composite of the duality isomorphism (relative to $E \otimes_S^L P'$ and $Q \otimes_S^L Q'$) and the base-change isomorphisms

$$f'_!(E \otimes_S^L P') \xrightarrow{\sim} f_! E \otimes_S^L P', \quad f^! Q \otimes_S^L Q' \xrightarrow{\sim} f'^!(Q \otimes_S^L Q').$$

Recall that a is the composite of the canonical arrow (SGA 4 XVIII 3.1.9.5)

$$f_* \text{RHom}(E, f^! Q) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(f_! E, f_! f^! Q)$$

and of the arrow defined by the adjunction arrow $f_! f^! Q \rightarrow Q$. There is an analogous description of a' , as the composite of the quoted arrow

$$f'_* \text{RHom}(E \otimes_S^L P', f'^!(Q \otimes_S^L Q')) \longrightarrow \text{RHom}(f'_!(E \otimes_S^L P'), f'_! f'^!(Q \otimes_S^L Q')),$$

of the arrows defined by c and d , and of the arrow defined by the adjunction arrow

$$f'_! f'^!(Q \otimes_S^L Q') \longrightarrow Q \otimes_S^L Q'.$$

By definition, d is adjoint to the arrow

$$f'_!(f^! Q \otimes_S^L Q') \longrightarrow Q \otimes_S^L Q'$$

defined by the base-change isomorphism $f'_!(f^! Q \otimes_S^L Q') \simeq f_! f^! Q \otimes_S^L Q'$ and the adjunction arrow $f_! f^! Q \rightarrow Q$; in other words, the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f'_!(f^! Q \otimes_S^L Q') & \xrightarrow{f'_! d} & f'_! f'^!(Q \otimes_S^L Q') \\ \downarrow \text{base ch. } \sim & & \downarrow \text{adj} \\ f_! f^! Q \otimes_S^L Q' & \xrightarrow{\text{adj} \otimes 1} & Q \otimes_S^L Q' \end{array}$$

is commutative. It follows that one may also describe a' as the composite of the arrow above, of the arrow defined by c , and of those defined by the base-change isomorphism

$$f'_!(f^!Q \otimes_S^L Q') \xrightarrow{\sim} f_!f^!Q \otimes_S^L Q'$$

and the adjunction arrow $f_!f^!Q \rightarrow Q$. This decomposition of a' and that of a given above, together with the commutativity of the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E, f_!f^!Q) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E \otimes_S^L P', f_!f^!Q \otimes_S^L Q') \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E, Q) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E \otimes_S^L P', Q \otimes_S^L Q'), \end{array}$$

defined by 2.2.4 and the adjunction arrow $f_!f^!Q \rightarrow Q$, show that, to establish the commutativity of 2.6.2, it suffices to prove the following compatibility.

Lemma 2.6.3

Let f, f', E, F, P', Q' be as in 2.6.1. Then one has a commutative square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f_*\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{(1)} & f'_*\mathrm{RHom}(E \otimes_S^L P', F \otimes_S^L Q') \\ (2) \downarrow & & \downarrow (4) \\ \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E, f_!F) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{(3)} & \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E \otimes_S^L P', f_!F \otimes_S^L Q'), \end{array}$$

where (1) is the composite of the base-change isomorphism

$$f_*\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \otimes_S^L - \xrightarrow{\sim} f'_*(\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \otimes_S^L -)$$

and $f'_*(2.2.4)$, (2) is deduced from the canonical arrow

$$f_*\mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \longrightarrow \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E, f_!F)$$

(SGA 4 XVIII 3.1.9.5) by applying $\otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q')$, (3) is given by 2.2.4, and finally (4) is the composite of the canonical arrow

$$f'_*\mathrm{RHom}(E \otimes_S^L P', F \otimes_S^L Q') \longrightarrow \mathrm{RHom}(f'_!(E \otimes_S^L P'), f'_!(F \otimes_S^L Q'))$$

(loc. cit.) and the arrows defined by the base-change isomorphisms

$$f'_!(E \otimes_S^L P') \xrightarrow{\sim} f_!E \otimes_S^L P', \quad f'_!(F \otimes_S^L Q') \xrightarrow{\sim} f_!F \otimes_S^L Q'.$$

Returning to the definition of the arrow (SGA 4 XVIII 3.1.9.5), choose a compactification of f ⁸; one is then reduced to proving the lemma separately in the case where f is an open immersion and in the case where f is a proper morphism.

⁸The arrow quoted is defined with the aid of such a compactification, but it does not depend on it: this point, tacitly admitted in (loc. cit.), is easily verified.

a) *Case where f is an open immersion.* By adjunction (2.2.1), it suffices to see that, if one tensors the square 2.6.3 by $f_!E \otimes_S^L P'$ and composes with the evaluation arrow 2.2.2

$$(f_!E \otimes_S^L P') \otimes^L \mathrm{RHom}(f_!E \otimes_S^L P', f_!F \otimes_S^L Q') \longrightarrow f_!F \otimes_S^L Q',$$

the square obtained is commutative. But the sums of this square are zero outside X' , so that it suffices to verify that the square induced on X' commutes, which is trivial.

b) *Case where f is a proper morphism.* Then $f_! = f_*$, $f'_! = f'_*$. One sees easily that the composite of

$$f_* \mathrm{RHom}(E, F) \longrightarrow \mathrm{RHom}(f_*E, f_*F)$$

with the trivial-duality isomorphism

$$\mathrm{RHom}(f_*E, f_*F) \xrightarrow{\sim} f_* \mathrm{RHom}(f^*f_*E, F)$$

is none other than the arrow deduced from the adjunction arrow $f^*f_*E \rightarrow E$ by applying $f_* \mathrm{RHom}(-, F)$. Similarly, the composite of (4) with the trivial-duality isomorphism

$$\mathrm{RHom}(f_*E \otimes_S^L P', f_*F \otimes_S^L Q') \xrightarrow{\sim} f'_* \mathrm{RHom}(f^*f_*E \otimes_S^L P', F \otimes_S^L Q')$$

($f_*F \otimes_S^L Q'$ being identified with $f'_*(F \otimes_S^L Q')$ by the canonical isomorphism) is none other than the arrow deduced from the adjunction arrow $f^*f_*E \rightarrow E$ by applying $f'_* \mathrm{RHom}(- \otimes_S^L P', F \otimes_S^L Q')$. Thus one is reduced to verifying the commutativity of the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{RHom}(f_*E, f_*F) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{(3)} & \mathrm{RHom}(f_*E \otimes_S^L P', f_*F \otimes_S^L Q') \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ f_* \mathrm{RHom}(f^*f_*E, F) \otimes_S^L \mathrm{RHom}(P', Q') & \xrightarrow{(1')} & f'_* \mathrm{RHom}(f^*f_*E \otimes_S^L P', F \otimes_S^L Q'), \end{array}$$

where the vertical arrows are the trivial-duality isomorphisms and (1') is (1) with E replaced by f^*f_*E . But this is a special case of 2.6.1.1 in the case, already treated, where (u, v) is of type (2, 1) (take $u : f^*f_*E \rightarrow f_*E$ given by the identity of f^*f_*E , and $v : F \rightarrow f_*F$ given by the identity of f_*F). We have therefore proved 2.6.3. As we have seen, the commutativity of 2.6.2 follows, which completes the proof of 2.6.1 and, finally, of 2.5.